



KENYATTA UNIVERSITY
INSTITUTE OF OPEN AND VIRTUAL LEARNING
DEPARTMENT OF PHYSICAL EDUCATION
EDU 210: THE PHILOSOPHY OF INCLUSIVE EDUCATION

UNIT 1

The Philosophy of Inclusive Education

Introduction

Welcome to Unit 1 of module 10: The Philosophy of Inclusion. In this unit, you will learn about the commonly used terms in enhancing inclusion of learners with special needs in the family, school and community. The unit also covers the objectives, principles and benefits of inclusive education practice of trying to address the learners' diversity in learning.

Aim

This unit is intended to equip you with knowledge and skills on the concepts, principles and benefits of inclusive education. It will also enable you to appreciate and perform your role as a teacher for learners with special needs effectively.



Objectives

By the time you complete this unit, you should be able to:

- Define the terms and clarify the concepts used in inclusive education.
 - Describe the objectives of inclusive education.
 - Discuss the principles of inclusive education
 - Explain the benefits of inclusive education
- This unit is divided into three sections

namely:

Section 1: Definition of terms and concepts in inclusive education.

Section 2: Objectives of inclusive education

Section 3: Principles and benefits of inclusive education

Section 1: Definition of terms and clarification of concepts used in inclusive education

There are various terms and concepts used in inclusive education. It is important that we clarify the main ones before we go further. They include:

- inclusion,
- inclusive education,
- inclusive setting
- learners diversity,
- resource room,
- integration/mainstreaming,
- itinerant or peripatetic services.

Let us now examine each of these terms and concepts briefly.

Inclusion

This is a philosophy that focuses on the process of adjusting the home, school and the larger society to accommodate persons with special needs including disabilities. All individuals regardless of their differences are accorded the opportunity to interact, play, learn, work and experience the feeling of belonging. They are also allowed to develop in accordance with their potentials and abilities.

The full and equal participation of each individual is assured in an inclusive society in which differences are respected and valued. Discrimination and bias against those who are considered different is eliminated through appropriate practices and policies.

Inclusion therefore calls for persons with special needs to be fully involved in all aspects of life.

These include:

- education,
- employment,
- access to consumer services such as electricity and clean water supply,
- recreational and social activities,
- community and domestic activities,
- decision making process,
- access to information.



What is inclusion about?

Inclusion is about the following:

- welcoming diversity,
- benefiting all learners with special needs and disabilities,
- children in school who may feel excluded,
- providing equal access to education for all children,
- continuous search to finding better ways of responding to diversity,
- identification and removal of barriers, stimulating creativity and problem solving by all. This requires the presence, participation and achievement of all learners.
- learners who risk marginalization, exclusion and/or underachievement,
- reforming schools and ensuring that every child receives quality and appropriate education within these schools,
- improving learning environments and providing opportunities for all learners to become successful in their learning experiences.



Inclusion should start from the beginning of life rather than having the individual segregated first and then later brought back into the mainstream of society.

Inclusive Setting

This is a situation where all learners including those with special needs and disabilities participate in all activities in a community. These learners' are recognized and their needs addressed as much as possible.

Inclusive Education

This is the philosophy of ensuring that schools, centres of learning and educational systems are open to all children. This enables the learners to be included in all aspects of school-life. It also means identifying, reducing or removing barriers within and around the school that may hinder learning. For this to happen, teachers, schools and systems need to modify the physical and social environment so that they can fully accommodate the diversity of learning needs that learners may experience.



An inclusive school includes learners with various diversitie and differentiates educational experiences to cater for the various diversities.

According to UNESCO (2001), inclusive education takes the Education for All agenda forward. This is done by finding ways of enabling schools to serve all children in their communities as part of an inclusive education system.

Inclusive education is concerned with all learners with a focus on those who have traditionally been excluded from educational opportunities. Such learners include

those with special needs and disabilities that you learnt about in Module 1: Introduction to Children with Special Needs.



List the Learners with special needs who have been excluded in educational provisions that are targeted by inclusive education.

Learners' Diversity



What do you understand by the term learners' diversity?

This term refers to the variations of abilities and differences found among any group of learners in any given setting. These variations and differences give rise to different learner characteristics as you learnt in Module 1: Introduction to learners' with Special Needs.



Observe the learners in your class, in any given activity. Note down differences in the way they carry out activities and discuss with a colleague.

You may have noted that some learners are active while others are passive, some are fast, but others are slow, one is good in one skill, but poor in another. You should aim at meeting the needs of all the learners in the learning process.

Resource room



What is a resource room?

This is a room in a regular or special school, which is equipped for enriching learning for learners with special needs. It is usually run by a resource room teacher who is a member of staff with appropriate experience or training in special needs education. She has a responsibility to advise and support other teachers and learners to deal with special educational needs in the classroom.

Itinerant or peripatetic teacher



Who is an itinerant or peripatetic teacher?

This is a teacher who is trained in special needs education and moves from school to school where children with special needs are included. The role of this teacher is to advise the regular teacher and give technical support where need arises. This teacher is also assigned to assist particular learners with special needs.

The teacher follows a programme, which is drawn up in consultation with the regular teacher, parent, siblings and/or peers to meet individual learners' needs.

Integration/Mainstreaming

The term refers to the participation of learners with special educational needs in regular education without demanding changes in the curricular provision. Such

children follow the school system as it is with some or no support. They are expected to adapt to the regular school arrangements.

Different professionals sometimes use the terms 'integration' and 'mainstreaming' interchangeably.



The term integration is mostly used in Europe and Kenya while mainstreaming is commonly used in America.

This provision reflects the attempts to place learners with special needs in the mainstream/regular education system. The focus remains on disability. There are three main forms of integration. These are:

- Functional integration
- Locational/physical integration
- Social integration

Let us now examine each of the above forms of integration.

Functional integration

This is a form of integration where the child with special needs is placed in the regular class. In some cases the learner is taken out to the resource room to be given modified instructions by the resource teacher, itinerant or special teacher in the area of special needs.

Locational/physical integration

In this form of integration the learner with special needs is placed in a special unit located in the regular school. In this case, the learners in the unit have limited interactions with those in the regular school. They are only able to mix with others

when they are out of classroom for example during break time. This leaves the integration physical or locational in nature. In Kenya, most of the special units especially those for children with mental disabilities are purely physical.

Social integration

In this form of integration the learner with special needs is placed in a special unit for learning purposes, but joins the peers in the regular classes for social activities like physical education, games and other co curricular activities.



What are some of the advantages and disadvantages of integration?

I hope you mentioned the following:

Advantages of integration

- the learners with special needs enjoy interactions with peers.
- it is less restrictive to the learners as they interact with others freely.
- gives an opportunity for learners without special needs to support those with special needs in various activities.

Disadvantages of integration:

- a learner with special needs may be excluded from learning activities while being locationally or socially included.
- learners with special needs may be labelled and stigmatised. This may lower their self-esteem and image.
- the learners with special needs may be ignored by teachers who may feel incompetent to assist them.



In integrated education the child is viewed as a problem with all kinds of needs, which are difficult or impossible to meet. Figure 1.1 shows the views of the integrated school about learners with special needs.

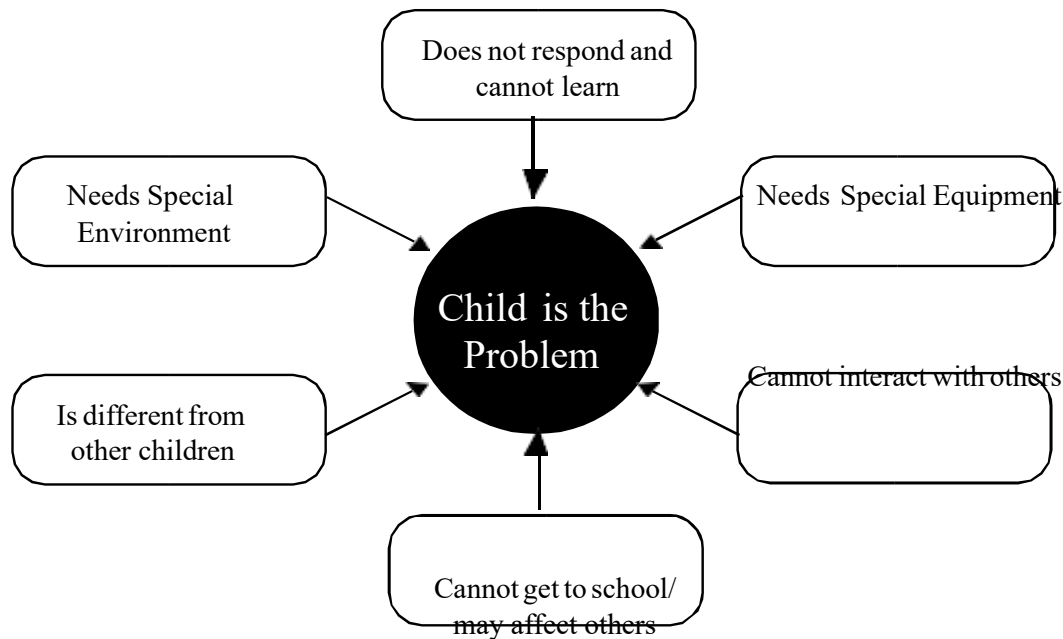


Figure 1.1: How a Learner with Special Needs in Education is viewed in an Integrated Education Programme



Study the illustration above carefully. How do you go about changing the attitudes of people so that the child is not seen as problem?



Discuss with a colleague.

Section 2: Objectives of Inclusive Education

I hope you enjoyed reading Section 1 of this unit and understood the terms and concepts covered. Let us now discuss the objectives of Inclusive Education.

As you are aware, learners have varying abilities that need to be addressed. In the previous section, you learnt that Inclusive education is the process of addressing all learners' needs within the regular school. This entails the use of all available resources to create opportunities for them to learn in preparing them for life.

Learners with Special Needs and their peers need to develop constructive and sustainable relationships. This is possible if mutual perceptions of shared experiences are availed through provision of well planned collaborative learning experiences.

The new trends in Special Needs provision suggest that the regular classroom is the first option of education for learners with special needs including those with disabilities. However, the choice of placement will depend on severity of special needs including disability.



This is the same as in health services where sick persons are provided with services according to their levels of sickness.

In the medical set up:

- most patients are treated at home or nearby clinic.
- other serious cases are admitted in the hospital.
- very few require treatment in intensive care unit.

Similarly:

- most learners with Special Needs can benefit in regular school.
- others may be

in
integrated
program
mes.

- a few will need to be

educated
in
special
schools.



What are the objectives of inclusive education?

Objectives of inclusive education include the following:

- providing a comprehensive educational plan that modifies the curriculum to give maximum opportunity to children with special needs in order for them to become productive members of society.
- developing positive attitude in parents, teachers, peers and the community at large towards children with special needs.
- providing equal opportunities to all children to share knowledge, resources and experiences.
- suggesting approaches to accommodate all children in regular classes regardless of their disabilities or abilities.
- developing and implementing a curriculum that is flexible and accessible to all children.
- reaching the unreached children and youth within regular education.
- facilitating inclusion of the learner in all aspects of life.
- identifying and minimising barriers to learning and development.
- minimizing the effects of disabilities on the child.

I hope you now appreciate that currently inclusive education is the most appropriate approach to providing education for all children regardless of their abilities and challenges.

However, there is still a lot to be done as noted in the World Education Forum Report, (2000). There are still more than 113 million children who have no access to primary education in the world.

Section 3: Principles and Benefits of Inclusive Education



What are the principles of inclusive education?

You may have included the following:

- calls for equal opportunities for all learners to experience normal mainstream activities, while making deliberate and appropriate measures to ensure quality education for all.
- calls for a child centred curriculum and the learner to attend the school that he/she would naturally go to in his community if she/he had no special needs.
- advocates for accessibility to the learning process and the curriculum by all learners by differentiating the learning and assessment process according to the learners needs.
- addresses the needs of all learners with visible or invisible learning difficulties such as visual, hearing, physical, intellectual, communication, behavioural and emotional, bereavements from HIV and AIDS, child abuse, poverty, malnourishment, emotional effects of wars, divorce and family separation and living on the street.
- recognizes and caters for individual differences in race, religion, abilities, disabilities or circumstances. Differences are only seen as challenges.
- plans for positive learning opportunities with support to learners with special needs as an integral part of the ordinary school.
- requires change of attitudes, behaviours, teaching methods, curricula and environments to meet the needs of all learners, hence overcoming barriers to learning and development.

- calls on special needs education service providers to work closely with others within the community such as health and social workers emphasizing prevention and intervention strategies to minimize the occurrence and the impact of disabilities in the community.



Around the world, more children from deprived backgrounds or with impairments are attending their local schools. However learners with severe disabilities will still require specialized training outside the regular classroom.

Inclusive culture in schools This

is characterized by:

- seeing differences among students and staff as resources.
- organizational features that support teaming among staff.
- a collaborative international style among staff and children
- leadership that is shared and distributed among formal leaders and staff.
- a willingness to struggle to sustain inclusive practices.
- an understanding of the socio – political nature of inclusion.
- the use of language and symbols to communicate ideals and spread commitment across the school and into the community.
- an uncompromising commitment and belief in inclusive education.
- a shared belief among staff and learners in the value of every adult and child as each brings a unique gift to their community.

Benefits of Inclusive Education



In your view, what are the benefits of inclusive education?

In inclusive education, all learners learn and grow in the environment that they will eventually live and work in. As participation of those who are “different” takes root, all learners and teachers gain the virtues of being accommodating, accepting, patient and co-operative. Other children gain some valuable virtues such as being considerate, patient and humble as they support their peers with special needs. Some learners with special needs are gifted with special abilities, which their peers can benefit from.

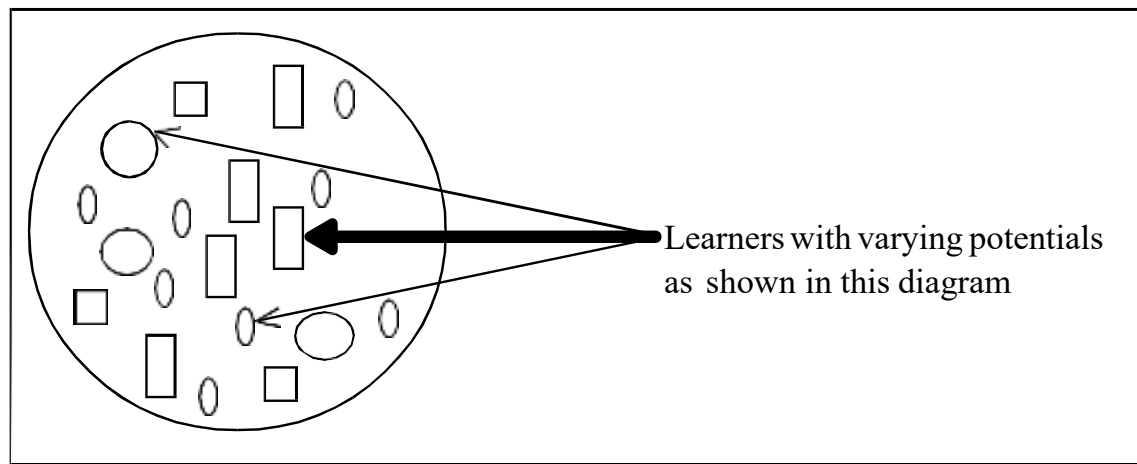
Teachers get to share ideas and knowledge with each other, parents and significant others, thus making education a meaningful aspect of everyday life. They also develop their skills and abilities when working as a team to address the challenges. This may also boost their status in the community.

Inclusive education creates ‘A School For All’ where everybody benefits resulting to an inclusive society. The self-esteem of the child with special needs in education is improved. It is cost effective and gives equal opportunities to all children thus promoting the rights of all to education.

As you already know, in an inclusive classroom, all learners:

- belong to the same group.
- help each other to learn and function.
- take considerations of each other’s needs.
- accept the fact that some children have needs that differ from the majority and will at times do different things from others.

Figure 1.2 to see an illustration of an inclusive classroom.



*Figure 1.2 An illustration of an Inclusive Classroom Set Up
(Adapted from Skjorten M. MD 1997)*

KEY



Learners with disabilities (fewer)



Learners with SNE (Few)



Regular learners (more)



What are the arguments against and for inclusive education?

Some of the arguments against inclusive education include the following:

- the teacher may end up with very big classes of learners with varying abilities making teaching difficult.
- If resources are not available and teachers not appropriately trained, it may fail.
- if attitudes are not changed the child would still be seen as a problem.

Arguments for inclusive education include the following:

- learners with disabilities achieve better school results in inclusive setting.
- it provides opportunities to build social networks, mutual assistance, and trustworthiness.

Benefits of Inclusion

The Association of Retarded Citizens (ARC), (Smith (1998) notes that inclusion brings benefits to both students and teachers as follows:

Benefits to Students

- students with disabilities have greater success in achieving Individualized Educational Programme goals than those in traditional programmes.
- students with special needs in education in general classes do better academically and socially than counterparts in non-inclusive settings.
- students with special needs gain self esteem, acceptance by class mates and social skills.
- the academic progress of non-disabled students is not slowed down by having peers in the classroom.
- benefits to regular learners include: ○ reduced fear of human differences ○ increased comfort and awareness ○ growth in social cognition ○ improvement in self concept ○ development of personal principles ○ warm and caring friendships.
- parents confirmed improved outcomes for their children without disabilities when children with disabilities were included in the classroom.

Benefits to teachers

- teachers learn a lot about disabilities from the learners and about treating each other with respect or openness by watching the learners interact.
- they move from using paper and pencil to using more manipulative and creative methods of teaching
- they use more collaborative problem solving approaches between learners.
- the class feels as a family hence all expected to participate in general form of activities.
- teamwork is promoted between teacher and support teacher, speech/occupational/physio therapists in order to reaching all children.



Students with disabilities are different but valuable. They deserve a place in a world that values them.

Three forms of educational provisions for learners with special needs have evolved over the years. These are:

- Special education,
- Integration
- Inclusive education.

Let us now compare these provisions.

You should noted that many people confuse inclusion and integration. The table below will help you to understand the differences between the various forms of educational provisions.

S/ N	Factor	Special	Integrated	Inclusive
1	Child	Special	Brought as near to “normal” as is possible.	The child remains as/she is.
2	Schoo	Special.	A selected “regular” school	The school that he/she would naturally go to in his/her community.
3	Curriculum Methodology	Special	Subject centred	Child centred or child focused
4	Teacher	Special educator	Class teacher, resource teacher itinerant teacher, specialist, consultant.	Skilled knowledgeable regular class teacher
5	Teacher effectiveness	Specific to a group of children.	Unchanged, able to teach regular children only.	Able to include all children in the learning process.
6	Self esteem	Low, feels different	Feels better	Feels good about self.
7	Environment	Most restrictiv	Unchanged	Least restrictive, spread evenly for all children
8	Opportunities for participation	Limited.	Partial	Equal for all children
9	Rights of the child to education	Charity orientated.	Recognised as a right but not realised.	Realised and actualised.

Comparisons Between The Three Forms of Provision For SNE



Integration is often confused with inclusive education. Using the table above identify the unique differences between the two forms of provision.



Discuss with a colleague.



Summary

You have come to the end of unit 1. In this unit you learnt about the main concepts and terms used in inclusive education such as inclusion, learner's diversity, integration and mainstreaming among others. You also learnt about the objectives of inclusive education such as the need to give equal opportunities to all learners in a flexible and barrier-free environment among others.

You learnt about the principles of inclusive education such as the value of positive change of attitude and child centred curriculum. Finally, benefits of inclusion to learners and teachers such as promotion of self-esteem, acceptance by peers and so on were also discussed.

I hope you have enjoyed studying this unit and that you'll use the information gained to respond positively to your learners, including those with special needs and disabilities.

You can now attempt the self test that follow.



Self Test Unit 1

Answer ALL questions

1. Which of the following statements best describes the philosophy of inclusive Education?

- A. all learners regardless of individual differences are excluded in some educational activities.

- B. all learners regardless of individual differences participate in all educational and community activities.
- C. considering their individual differences, all learners should be involved in all educational activities as much as possible.
- D. all the above.

(1 mark)

2. Differentiate between integration and inclusive education.

(4 marks)

3. Many regular schools with a special unit have a resource room to support the integrated learners in the classroom. List any four(4) examples of resources that you would expect to find in the room.

(2 marks)

4. Match the phrases in List A with the appropriate responses in List B

List 'A'

- a. Special Schools
- b. A cost effective education provision
- c. A powerful tool to educational reform

List 'B'

- a. Inclusive Education
- b. Policy and legal framework
- c. promote segregation of learners with SNE

(3 marks)

Score Board

9 - 10	- Very Good	☐
7 - 8	- Good	☐
5 - 6	- Satisfactory	☐
0 - 4	- Read the Unit again	☐



Learners Outcomes

You have now completed Unit 1. The learning outcomes are listed below. Put a tick in the column which best reflects your understanding of the content covered in this Unit.

No.	Self evaluation	Sure	Not Sure
1.	I can now define the main terms and concepts used in inclusive education	☐	☐
2.	I can now explain the objectives of inclusive education	☐	☐
3.	I can now explain the principles and benefits of including learners with special needs in regular schools.	☐	☐

If you have put a tick at the not sure column, please go back and study that section in the unit before proceeding. If you are sure, go on to the next Unit.



Congratulations!

Unit 2

Components of Inclusive Education

Introduction

Welcome to Unit 2 of module 10: Components of Inclusive Education. In this unit, you will learn about the various components that need to be addressed for successful implementation of inclusive education.

Aim

This unit aims at enabling you to understand the components necessary for successful implementation of inclusive Education.



Objectives

By the end of this unit, you should be able to:

- discuss the school factors that facilitate the implementation of inclusive education.
- describe support services and resources that are required to facilitate inclusive education.
- discuss collaboration and community involvement in inclusive education.

The unit is divided into three sections

Section 1: School factors

Section 2: Support services and resources

Section 3: Collaboration and community involvement

Best of luck!

Section 1: The School Factors

I hope you now understand the principle goal of inclusive education and the part you can play to help achieve it in your school. In this section you will learn about the various school factors that are necessary for the achievement of inclusive education. These will include the following:

- classroom factors
- student factors
- teacher factors
- curriculum

Let us now look at each of the factors:

Classroom factors



What are the important factors you need to consider for successful implementation of inclusive classroom?

I hope you mentioned the following factors among others:

- assessment
- keeping records
- organising space
- planning the learning experience
- establishing classroom rules

- interactive relationships
- organizing play activities
- preventing behaviour problems

Let us examine each of these aspects.

Assessment

In assessment you will need to identify the learners who may be experiencing difficulties. You should be able to recognise the barriers within the child and in the environment that may hinder learning. This will enable you to plan for each learner appropriately.



What barriers to learning and development are you likely to come across among learners in your classroom? Name one indicator for each barrier.

I hope you mentioned the following among others:

<u>Barrier</u>	<u>Indicator(s)</u>
• visual difficulties	– learner holding the book too close or too near the face or missing parts of words when reading.
• hearing difficulties	– learner cocking the head on one side or cupping the ear as he/she listens.
• physical difficulties	– posture and motor co-ordination difficulties.
• learning difficulties	– learner experiencing difficulties in specific subjects like reading, writing and arithmetic.
• communication difficulties	– learner stammering or unable to communicate with others.
• emotional and behaviour difficulties	– Learner withdrawn or aggressive.

You need to know the implications of each of these barriers to the learning process and what you can do to assist the learner to overcome them. You will learn more about the barriers in their implications and interventions in unit 4 of this module.



It is important to get an expert opinion on a learner's area of need to avoid mislabelling. Consult colleagues and refer difficult cases to the assessment centre for further assistance.

Keeping records

It is important that you keep records for each learner. This will enable you to monitor their progress. The records should include family background, medical information as well as individualized educational plans and progress records. The individualized Educational Programme (IEP) needs to be updated and reviewed periodically.

Organizing Space

The learners' needs met at designated areas in the classroom. This requires you to plan and organize the available space in your classroom. For example, you may have the following learning centres:

- nature centre
- garden
- shopcorner
- post office
- subject centres for example
 - Music
 - Mathematics



What are some of the considerations you will take in organising space for learners with diverse needs?

I hope you mentioned the following:

- a learner using a wheel-chair will require more space for free movement.
- learners with low vision may have to be placed near the chalkboard, window or source of light.

- those with hearing problems to be seated in front or at an appropriate position to enable them see the teachers' face.
- those with behaviour difficulties who are constantly out of their seats should be seated between two children to bar them from getting out unnecessarily.

You may teach learners as a whole class, in groups, in pairs or individually. When grouping learners, you need to consider their diversities. For example, ability grouping should aim at learners with same needs progressing together, while mixed ability grouping should aim at creating and encouraging environment where those experiencing problems gain as they learn alongside those with higher abilities. Pairing should aim at having the gifted learners supporting those with learning difficulties.

Planning the learning experience

When planning learning experiences you should consider the individual learner's needs. You can do this by:-

- organizing the classroom to address the learner's difficulties, for example having the learner sit close to the teacher or away from too much light
- modifying the teaching style to incorporate more group activities where each learner participates.
- encouraging learners to help each other rather than competing.
- organizing learning activities for learners with diversities.

Establishing Classroom Rules

An environment that is consistent, supportive, encourages and promotes learning. An inclusive classroom with a diversity of learners requires simple rules to enhance

positive behaviour and minimize disruptions. You will learn more about this in module 11 – Emotional and Behaviour Management.

Effective classroom rules should be:-

- few in number.
- positively and simply stated.
- easy to enforce.
- developed and owned by the learners.
- placed on the wall as reminder to all learners.

The table below gives examples of negatively and positively stated classroom rules:

No.	Negatively stated	Positively
1	Do not make noise	Work quietly
2	Do not litter the class	Keep the classroom tidy
3	Do not give random answers	Put up your hand to answer
4	Do not dress like a clown	Be smart



Involve your learners to formulate five rules for your classroom and place them on the wall.

Interactive relationships

All children need a close, sensitive and loving relationship with those they spend time with. This is the basis for the development of the child's sense of security, confidence and the ability to cope with others and the world.

As the class teacher, you can create interactive relationships among the learners by:

- encouraging learners who finish their work early to work with others experiencing learning difficulties as peer tutors and note-takers.
- encouraging learners to interact and share tasks and responsibilities with each other.
- working to develop positive attitudes among pupils, teachers, and parents about learners with special needs.
- setting class activities to be completed by groups.
- encouraging learners to befriend peers with special needs and assist those with mobility problems during break time and games time.

Organizing play activities

As the children grow, they need the freedom to explore and play. Play is very important for the child's learning and development as you will learn in Module 14: Curriculum Development and Adaptation



What is the importance of play in the child's growth and development ?

I hope you mentioned that through play children achieve the following:

- mental development
- social skills
- physical development
- creativity
- curiosity
- confidence to move and manipulate the environment.



As a teacher, you need to encourage use of play in learning activities. Play forms the basis for handling school work and life issues.

Preventing Behaviour difficulties

Even in a well organized inclusive classroom, behaviour problems may occur. As a teacher, you should strive to make the learners feel good and reinforce desirable behaviour. However, when you detect a learner is experiencing a behaviour problem that may interfere with the learning, try to communicate your displeasure in a manner that will not disrupt the learning. You should avoid drawing attention to the learner or demoralising him/her. In some cases the learner may be seeking attention and your harsh response may be reinforcing the behaviour.

You will learn more about this in Module 11: Emotional and Behaviour Management

Student factors

It is important to note that every child is a unique individual. You need to recognize and address the following aspects concerning each learner:

- the learner's level of ability
- areas of special needs
- learning process
- learning styles

Let us explain each of these:

The learner's level of ability

In Unit 1 Section 1, you learnt about the term learner's diversity.



What does the term learners' diversity mean?

To refresh your memory it means learners in an inclusive setting have different abilities. For example, some learners could be:

- slow and others fast.
- neat and others careless.
- organized and others disorganized.
- good at some activities and poor in others.
- friendly and others aggressive.
- playful while others are withdrawn.

As a teacher, you need to be sensitive to each learner's abilities when planning various learning activities. You can do this by recognizing the various levels of achievement by the learners and planning your teaching with their needs in mind. You will learn more about this in Unit 3 of this Module.

Area of special need

Under assessment you learnt about some of the barriers that you may come across among your learners.

Each of these barriers poses a unique need for the individual learner. For instance:

- learners who experience difficulties in communicating in spoken language may need sign language and written language.
- the learner with a visual problem may require instructions and learning experiences that demand more tactual and listening processes. Similarly, the learner with hearing problems will need to see the teachers and peers' actions as they speak in the learning experiences.

- those with physical problems may need more adaptive devices and a modified physical environment for easy movement.
- learners with emotional and behavioural problems may require more counselling and positive reinforcement in their learning experiences.
- learners with hearing impairments may need preferential seating besides alternative modes of communication.
- learners with specific learning difficulties may need remedial work.
- learners with mental disabilities may require the use of real objects in order to develop concepts.

Learning Process

As you are already aware, learning is a process that takes place right throughout one's life. It is a relatively permanent change of behaviour due to experience or practice. It takes place in any environment the learner is exposed to and through a process. It follows therefore that, all learners including those with special needs learn through six learning processes. The six processes are:

- cognitive abilities
- visual sense
- auditory sense

- tactile sense
- sensory motor • speech and language.

Let us discuss them briefly.

Cognitive Ability

Cognitive ability enables the learner to understand, think, reason, pay attention, criticise, store, retrieve, interpret, organise and categorise information among others. Learners with special needs may have different cognitive abilities and hence, differences in learning pace.



What are the cognitive abilities that enhance learning.
List them down and discuss with a colleague.

I hope you mentioned the following:

- attention: the learner should be able to concentrate on the task at hand.
- recognition: present the material in an interesting manner considering the learner's ability
- perception: ability to tell differences between objects, shapes, and sounds among others.
- discrimination: ability to tell differences between objects, shapes, and sound among others
- classification: ability to tell similarities and differences in objects, number, letters, sounds and so on.

- sensory integration: learning through integration of senses such as seeing, modelling and saying numbers
- concept formation: refers to a mental picture of an idea, event or object. In the absence of the senses the brain would have no sensory input hence the learner will miss vital information from the environment.

Visual Sense

A lot of what we learn is through the visual sense. This means that the eye is the most important organ through which information is sent to the brain.

Recognition and discrimination is usually through seeing. In order to utilize the visual sense effectively, the learner should be able to develop the following skills.

- visual skills which involve the use of the eyes in the environment.
- visual perception: awareness and attention which involves interpretation of what one sees. Some learners with special needs may have visual perception problems without necessarily having visual problems. Teachers need to provide activities that develop the visual perception skills such as using real objects when teaching.

Auditory Sense

It is important for you to know that besides the sense of sight, we learn a lot through the sense of hearing. Learners who have visual problems depend heavily on clear descriptions of what they cannot see to help them create visual images.

Therefore, the auditory sense is an important channel for learning.



What are some of the factors which promote the use of the sense of hearing?

I hope you mentioned the following:

- environmental sounds: it is important for a learner to be aware and attend to environmental sounds.
- sound recognition and : association: this helps a learner to attach meaning to words.
- auditory discrimination: Identifying specific sounds heard. The learner should be able to name sources of sound for example sounds of different animals.

Interpreting Verbal Instruction

Learners need to be guided to attend to speech that provides directions and instructions.

Auditory Skills and Listening in learning

This involves attending keenly to auditory input, locating the source of sound and attaching meaning to what he/she hears. Listening is a skill that should be taught particularly to learners with special needs such as those with hearing problems.

Auditory Memory

For learning to take place, learners should be able to store auditory experiences, retrieve and relate them when it is desirable. The learner needs to remember, discriminate, relate sounds to meaning and blend speech sounds such as house ha/u/s.

Tactile Sense

This involves touching and feeling of objects through manipulation using fingers, hands or other parts of the body. The following aspects are developed through the sense of touch.

- awareness and attention is marked by touching and feeling and models which enhances the identification of texture.
- structure and shape: This is learnt by moving the hands along objects, grasping and manipulating.

- relationship of parts of the whole, for example, in case of jigsaw puzzles where pieces are separated and joined together to make a whole object.
- graphic representation which involves making an object to represent the actual form of the object giving a mental image.
- braille symbols for learners who cannot read or write print.

Sensory Motor Learning

This refers to the input from senses and output through motor activity. Perceptual development occurs through sensory motor activities and correspond to sensory feedback. The foundation of learning is established through the integration of sensory feedback to the brain expressed in sensory motor activities such as; eye hand coordination, grossmotor and fine motor skills.

Speech and Language

There are two aspects of language namely:

- receptive language: concerned with receiving information and reacting to it. A learner with receptive difficulties is likely to miss out a lot of information in class hence experience academic and social problems.

Learners with receptive language problems have difficulties in listening, carrying out instructions, responding appropriately to information either spoken, written or signed or communicated by any other means like reading, interpreting signs, gestures and so on.

- expressive Language: This is concerned with production or formulating and using spoken, written, signed or brailled language. Learners with expressive language problems have difficulties in speaking, signing, writing or brailing information. In class, learners with expressive language problems is likely to be withdrawn, or reserved making it difficult for the teacher to evaluate whether he/she has understood or not.



You will learn more about the learning process in module 16: Teaching and Learning Strategies.

Learning style

This refers to the way that a learner will receive information for example:

- listening to it repeatedly
- writing it.



Refer to Modules 1 and 7. Introduction to Children with Special Needs and Early Childhood Care. Development and Education respectively. For more information.

Teacher Factor and Teaching Methods

The classroom teacher is the most important person in the process of including a learner with special needs in a regular classroom. The teacher may make it possible for the learner to be accepted by other learners through demonstrating positive and supportive attitude to the learner. Conversely, being negative towards the learner with special needs may block any chances of learning in a regular class.



How would you enhance the inclusion of a learner with special needs in your class?

I hope you mentioned the following actions:

- making the learner feel welcome and an important member of the class for example by talking to him and encouraging him to participate in the class activities;
- encouraging the other learners to support the one with special needs in class and out of class;
- providing appropriate materials and learning experiences to the learner;

- talking to other teachers about the needs of the learner and discussing what can be done collectively to minimize barriers to learning and development;
- working closely with the learner's parents to assist in and out of school by planning and helping with homework;

- adapting the class work to meet the learner's needs;
- giving the learner extra instruction time whenever necessary;
- planning group work and using peer tutoring to help the learners with special needs participate in learning;
- addressing the special needs of individual learners;
- building your capacity through inservice courses, seminars and workshops in order to cope with increasing demands of learners with special needs.



How can you enhance inclusive education?

Some of the ways through which you can enhance inclusive education are:

- Diversifying teaching methods
- Differentiating curriculum
- Promoting collaborative learning.
- Enhancing communication.

Let us now discuss each of them.

Diversifying Teaching Methods

For the teacher to effectively assist the learner with special needs, she/he must use a variety of teaching approaches. These should be appropriate to the learners' ability and learning process.



What approaches can you use to teach learners with special needs in a regular classroom?

These approaches include the following among others:

- peer tutoring
- group teaching
- individualized instruction
- team teaching

Let us discuss each of the above briefly.

Peer Tutoring

This is the method of using other children to assist those experiencing difficulties in learning activities. Children learn most from one another by doing things together and using their own experiences and language, which is understood to their peers. This approach recognizes learners including those with special needs as a learning resource.

Group teaching



What is group teaching?

This is the process of placing learners in small groups of between 4 – 8 to enable the teacher conduct in a whole class or to individual learners for the purpose of learning effectively.

This is particularly effective if the members of the group are of mixed abilities and/ or same ability. The task may be planned in such a way that each member does a bit of the task so that all can contribute to the finished product. The learner with special needs can get a simpler task, which is required in the whole task. Remember to reinforce the learners' good work when they succeed in carrying out a task.

Individualized Instruction

The teacher may initiate an individualized education programme for the learner who is experiencing difficulties in learning. This should be done in collaboration with others who are knowledgeable about the curriculum requirements as well as the appropriate adaptations that are possible for the learners with special needs to access the curriculum. The parents or care givers should be involved in drawing up the plan as they may identify aspects of the curriculum that they feel are essential for the child.



What can you do to plan individualized instructions to meet the needs of a learner experiencing learning difficulties in your class?

I hope you mentioned the following:

- identify what the learner can and cannot do;
- establish how the difficulty or disability affects his or her involvement and progress in the general curriculum;
- plan work for the learner by setting realistic goals considering his/her abilities and challenges;
- establish and provide for any special education and other related services. This may include modification or support for school personnel working with the learner to enable him/her participate fully in academic and other activities;
- establish and recommend for modifications of examination administration at all levels of education.



It is important for the teacher to understand that each learner is an individual with unique needs, which must be addressed in the learning process.

You will learn how to draw an individualized education program in Unit 3 of this module and in Module 16: Teaching and Learning Strategies.

Team Teaching

This refers to teachers conducting lessons together so that they can share their expertise to assist learners' experiencing difficulties in the school.



The current traditional teacher closes the door in the classroom as s/he teaches, and the learners are at the mercy of what and how s/he chooses to deliver the learning experience with no one else to improve or critique the approach.

We realise that a teacher's job is not easy, particularly with a big class population of 50 learners or more. Having some learners with special needs will often mean more work. However, the learner's different needs may be met if you get help and support from colleagues, parents, and other professionals in the community such as social workers.

In team teaching, members may assist one another by:

- planning together
- teaching together
- evaluating the results together
- modifying the learning goals regularly together as illustrated below.

Promoting Collaborating learning

Collaborating learning and co-operative learning are used interchangeably. This is based on the idea that children learn from one another by doing activities together. Learning is organised in such a way that learners work with their peers towards a common goal rather than competing with one another. It enhances the spirit of pulling together in learners, which promotes the skill of sharing ideas, and responsibilities, listening to each other and working together in order to succeed.

They learn to control their emotions, make decisions, develop tolerance with each other, and take turns in speaking or doing things and being accountable. Therefore, enhances inclusion of learners with special needs and disabilities.

Collaboration therefore enhances inclusion of learners with special needs including disabilities.

Enhancing Communication

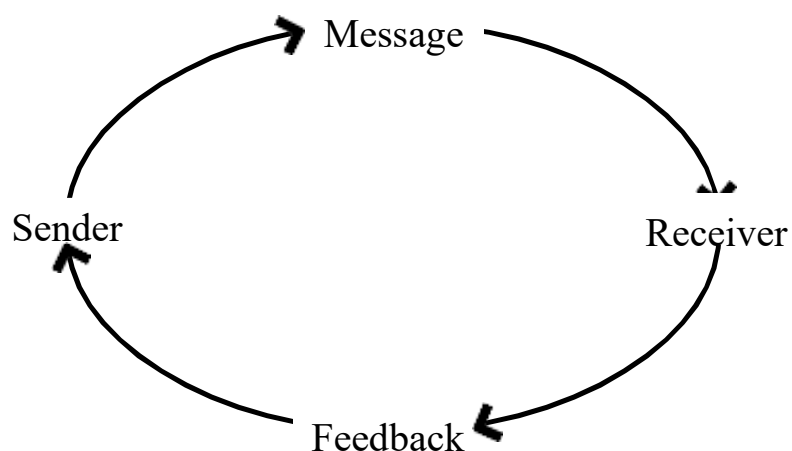
As you are already aware, communication is a two way process which depends on:-

- (i) understanding of what has been said.
- (ii) Being understood.

In communication there must be:-

- sender
- the message to be sent
- a feedback.

This is best referred to as communication chain illustrated by the diagram below.



If you break the communication chain at any stage, there will be a breakdown in communication for example when the sender uses a mode of communication, which the receiver does not understand. In class you may use a language like English to a learner who has just been enrolled in school from an area dominated by a local language. Such a learner may not understand the English language thus making his learning very difficult.

Likewise a learner with communication difficulties is likely to experience a breakdown in communication when trying to communicate with others because he/she may not have a good mastery of a particular mode of communication. So it is very important that you find the best communication channel to facilitate or relay information.



With your colleague list some modes of communication that you may use with your learners in class.

Curriculum Factors

Let us first define the term curriculum.

Curriculum refers to the subject matter that is planned to be taught learnt by the learners at any level of education. It provides guidelines on the content, sequence of activities, teaching methods, educational resources, time schedules and evaluation procedures. The Curriculum framework aims at reaching the average learner. For learners with special needs, the regular curriculum requires to undergo some modifications. This may result to a differentiated curriculum.

You will learn more about curriculum modifications in module 14: Curriculum

Development and Adaptations.



Inclusive Education calls for the recognition that all pupils may not do the same work in the same way at the same speed. This requires flexibility in terms of the content and teaching approaches to meet each learners needs.

Differentiated Curriculum



What then is a differentiated curriculum?

This means attempting to modify the regular curriculum to meet the individual needs of your learners. You can do this by: -

- manipulating the environmental factors.
- adapting the teaching approaches and time schedules

- modifying the content.
- adapting the exam questions and assessment procedures.
- providing appropriate learning materials to meet the learner's individual needs
- including other relevant and vital subjects for life long education required by some learners with special needs in education such as:
 - Independent living skills
 - Sign language
 - Braille
 - Orientation and mobility among others



Establish in your class a learner who cannot cope with the regular curriculum that you are implementing and suggest the modifications that you will do for him/her in order to cope with the learning activities.

Section 2: The Support Services and Resources Factor

Learners with special needs require basic support services for learning to be effective in an inclusive setting. The following are some important support services that should be made available to the learner with special needs in the regular class:

- resource room
- itinerant services
- educational resources
- parental support
- technical support such as sign language interpreter and braille transcriber

- teacher –aide
- peer support
- physiotherapy
- guidance and counselling
- occupational therapy
- speech therapy
- community support
- equipment

Let us discuss each of these support services briefly

Resource room

The idea of a resource room was introduced to you in Unit 1 of this Module.



What do you expect to find in a resource room?

I hope you mentioned the following among others:

- brailers and other braille writing equipment for the learners who are totally blind.
- low vision devices for learners with low vision such as magnifying lenses, spectacles, reading stands and large print books.
- hearing aids for the learners with hearing difficulties.
- Speech training kits for training learners with speech difficulties.
- audio-visual aids, charts, writing cards, traditional cutlery such as gourds, and calabashes among others.



A resource room may serve more than one school since it is expensive to set up. The possibility of having many learners with special needs in a cluster of schools is low. The current special schools can act as resource centres for the neighbouring schools to assist learners with special needs.

Itinerant /Peripatetic teacher Service

The services offered by the itinerant/peripatetic teacher are referred to as itinerant services.

The case study in Appendix 1 of this module demonstrates how this service may operate to support inclusion of learners with special needs in the regular class.



Read the case study in Appendix 1 carefully and cite the roles you can play in assisting learners with SNE and their teachers if you were to start itinerant services in your area.

I hope you mentioned roles of itinerant teacher as follows:

- checking the attendance of the learners to be assisted;
- establishing a resource centre to serve the schools in the region;
- liaising with organizations that can assist learners with disabilities such as Kenya Society for the Blind and The Kenya Society for Deaf Children among others for supplies of specified materials and equipment;
- liaising with the teachers of the different learners to teach the subjects at different time;.
- preparing materials and equipment for various learners;
- withdrawing some learners from the classroom for specific technical subjects such as braille, sign language, orientation and mobility;
- transcribing work into braille for the teacher to use with learners who have visual impairment;
- organizing in-service training and workshops for teachers;
- offering guidance and counselling services to teachers and learners;
- attending further training to develop required skills;
- discussing with the classroom teacher the difficulties and needs of learners with special needs;
- assisting the teachers in adapting and modifying parts of the curriculum contents and in preparing instructional materials;

- giving advice and information on special needs and disabilities to teachers and parents;
- networking with other community workers such as rehabilitation officers, and health personnel;
- visiting families of children with special needs and offering guidance and counselling services;
- organizing courses on special needs education for teachers and parents among others for example on total communication to aid comprehension.
- promoting the use of total communication to aid comprehension.

Educational Resources

As you learned in module 4: Introduction to Educational Resources Theory, there are both human and material resources that are necessary to support learners with special needs. They may include equipment and devices such as brailers, wheelchairs, walkers and crutches made from local materials to help learners with mobility difficulties. You should therefore encourage the classmates, friends and siblings to assist the learner to and from school and during school time.



Most of the educational resources for learners with special needs may be expensive to buy and maintain. However, you can use your innovation to improvise and use the available resources in the community including the local artisans and locally available materials as much as possible.

Parental Support

Parental support is important in the learning of a child. The support given makes the child feel loved and appreciated as a valuable member of the family, worthy of being educated, like other children in the family. For effective inclusion of learners with special needs there is need for you to collaborate with parents. Parents can offer very

vital information about their children because they have been with them during the whole period of growth and development.

Technical Support

This includes Sign Language interpreters for learners with hearing problems, braille transcribers and readers for learners with visual problems, having role models to come and talk to learners on certain topics can be quite motivating.

Teacher- Aide Support

In an Inclusive classroom some learners may need support in working out given activities. This support ensures that what the teacher has demonstrated is carried out by all learners through the assistance of a teacher aide. Peer Support



In what ways can peers give support to learners with special needs in an inclusive classroom?

I hope you mentioned the following:

- assisting in academic work such as reading
- pushing the wheel-chair for wheel-chair users
- guiding and reading for those with visual problems
- turning pages for those with motor co-ordination problems
- taking notes and clarifying instructions for those with hearing problems



Peer acceptance as demonstrated in support services enhances a sense of belonging among the learners in the classroom.

Physiotherapy

Physiotherapy support helps to provide physical exercises that strengthen the muscles for learners with motor problems. This in turn promotes the child's ability to move and manipulate learning materials. This enables the child with special needs to interact with others particularly during physical education and other practical subjects such as agriculture.

Occupational Therapy

Occupational therapy helps the learner in functional abilities given the limitations of the disability. For example adapting the writing tool for the child with poor grasp or training him/her in how to get into and out of the wheel chair. In the inclusive class the learner may gain both writing skill and the pace such that he/she is not left behind much by the other learners particularly when copying notes.

Guidance and Counselling



What is guidance and counselling?

This refers to the act of providing information for the purpose of making an informed decision. It involves a process which is interactive between the counsellor and the counselee in a professional setting. This is initiated and maintained as a means of facilitating meaningful understanding of self and environment. This results in change of behaviour of the counselee.

In an inclusive setting, counselling may be required by parents, classmates and learners with cognitive or behaviour problems. Some learners especially those living under difficult circumstances that you learnt about in Module 1: Introduction to Learners with Special Needs may require guidance and counselling services.

Guidance and counselling should also be geared towards all learners to accept those with special needs including those with disabilities. Parents may need guidance and counselling or information on their child's needs. Your role as a teacher is to provide services as well as referring them to other offices for further support services such as Educational Assessment and Resource Centre (EARC) and other professionals.

Community Support

For effective inclusive class learning you have to liaise with all persons in the community to provide support services for the child with special needs. Local carpenters, technicians, artisans and religious leaders among others may give services according to their professionals abilities. For example, a carpenter may make a walking aid f

Equipment

Let us now briefly look at some of the special equipment that may assist learners with special needs. These are illustrated in table 2.1.

Type of Equipment	Area of Special Needs
Audiological equipment such as Individual Hearing aids	Hearing Impairment
Mobility cane	Visual problems
Braille machine	Blindness
Wheel-chair/crutches	Mobility problems
Adapted desks	Physical/visual impairment
Spectacles and magnifying lenses	Low vision
Audio- visual aids such as T.V, radio	Mental disabilities, Autism, Specific Learning difficulties
Musical instruments such as flutes piano and abacus	Mental disabilities, Autism and emotional and behaviour difficulties

Some Equipment and devices for use by Persons with Special Needs



Refer to Module 4: Educational Resources – Theory for more information

Section 3: Collaboration and Community Involvement

It is important to note that you may not have all the skills required to meet the educational needs of all learners in the classroom. Individual teachers need support systems that provide collaborative assistance to enable them practice co-operative problem solving. Teamwork is the answer to effective inclusive education.

This can be done through:-

- parental involvement
- community involvement
- partnership and networking
- school management involvement
- interactive relationships
- home based programmes.

Let us examine how these factors may be effected for inclusive education:

Parental Involvement

Inclusive schools should encourage parental participation by:

- engaging parents to be co-teachers for their children for example by reviewing given homework;
- recognizing parents knowledge and influence in their children's behaviour, lives and learning processes. Remember the parents have a history, a present and a future with their child;
- encouraging parents to show interest in their children's work and providing learning reinforcement opportunities at home;

- giving information to parents concerning causes, prevention and intervention measures of special needs as well as available services and support groups;
- involving parents in decision making about the services to be provided to the learner;
- offering guidance and counselling services to the parents and family members on their roles in supporting the learner to overcome difficulties. For example, Jane Nyambuto summarizes her predicament and her parents support thus:

‘After recovering from polio, I could not walk anymore. My sisters and brothers and friends went to school and I wanted to go too. My father carried me to school, talked to the teacher and convinced them to accept me. I was the best pupil. My father had made the effort and I had to do my best too.’

Community Involvement

All stakeholders in the community in which the learner lives have a part to play in his/her learning and development.



What is a community?

A community is a group of people living together and sharing available resources. The school as a community should develop a positive and welcoming climate to the learner with special needs by:

- sensitizing other learners to work with and support their peers with special needs in their classes since they are members of the same community;
- encouraging other teachers to be positive when working with learners who have special needs in the school as they are rightful members of the community;
- counselling the other workers and parents of regular learners to accept the learners with special needs in the school;

- raising awareness of the needs of learners with special needs in the school and community through public “barazas”, religious or cultural forums;
- mobilizing community resources for example local artisans to work with/ for the learners with special needs in the community;
- ensuring physical facilities such as social halls are made accessible for use by learners with special needs and other groups whenever needed;
- removing physical barriers in the environment that may hinder mobility for learners with special needs as they attend school and other social functions;



As a member of the community, how can you assist a learner with mobility difficulties to access the local school?

I hope you mentioned the following:

- asking the local artisan to make mobility aids such as white cane, crutches or walking stick for the learner.
- sensitizing the members of the community to remove physical barriers from the route to school.
- encouraging the learners’ classmates and siblings to accompany the learner to and from school.

Partnership and networking

The task of educating learners with special needs in an inclusive class cannot be achieved single handedly. The community, administration leaders and advocates of special needs including disabilities need to consult on inclusive education.

Their forums could be used as a base for coordinating interdisciplinary activities necessary to support learners with special needs including those with disabilities. This can be achieved at all levels as shown in figure 2.2 below:

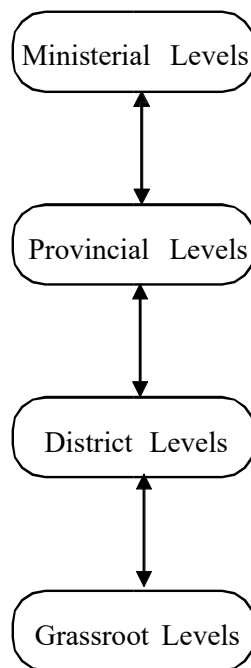


Fig 2.2: Support services for learners with special needs in education.

The above proposal will promote more positive partnership and networking which will improve service provision to learners with SNE in the

school and community. Positive development of learners with SNE depends on the co-operation between all stakeholders.

At all levels, consultation between various sectors such as health, education social services and voluntary organizations should be encouraged. This should be done in a two –way approach that is; bottom-up and top-bottom approaches. Exchange of information and plans will reduce chances of duplication of services and the current competition among service providers.



What are the relevant sectors that need to work with teachers to support learners with special needs.

I hope you named the following among others:

- health services
- social services
- youth groups
- religious organizations
- education
- associations of and for persons with disabilities.

Figure 2.2 illustrates collaboration among key players to support learners with special needs in education.

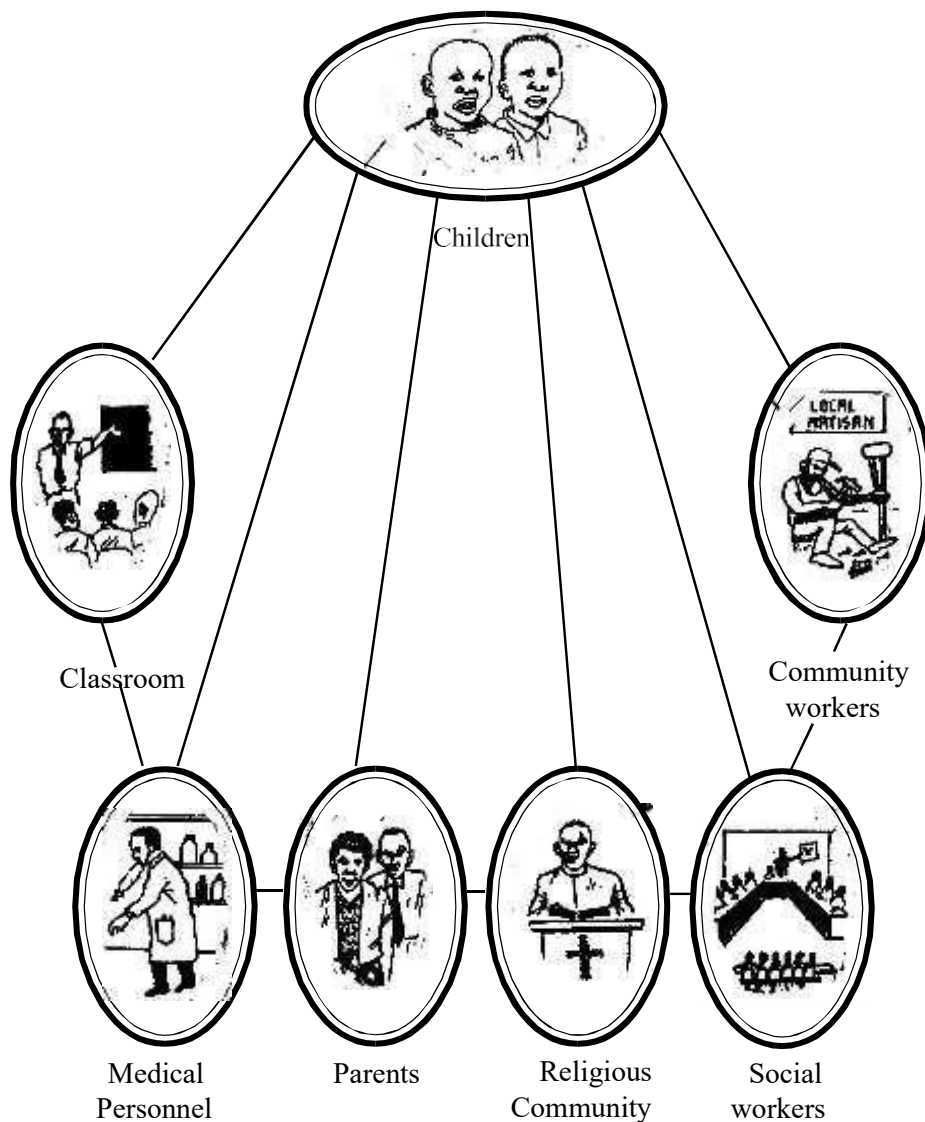


Fig 2.2: Collaboration of all stakeholders to support learners with Special Needs

School Management

school personnel need a comprehensive and systematic staff development and time to be availed for collaboration. This can be done by:

- local administrators and school managers playing major roles in making

schools more responsive to learners with special needs.

- heads of schools promoting positive attitudes throughout the school community.
- involving teachers and other staff to solve learning problems.
- providing students with aids and support services such as:
 - Brailers, wheelchairs, hearing aids and so on.
 - Teacher aides on part-time or full time basis.
 - Therapy/health services such as physiotherapy, speech therapy and occupational therapy among others.
 - Peer support.
 - Use of computer – aided technology.
 - For example a software used by learners who are blind referred to as Job Access With Speech (JAWS)
- Building teams for to plan and implement programmes
- scheduling time for teachers to work together



It is important that neighbouring schools practice collaboration to compare the difficulties they may be facing and practices that are working. This however may not be easy given the competition that exists between schools.

Teachers can mark together in the following ways:

- noting down the difficulties experienced by children with special needs in education.
 - brainstorming on challenges affecting colleagues in teaching learners with special needs in education.
-

- laying down plans to assist the teacher in the difficult areas through team planning and evaluation.
- modifying the strategies.
- trying out what is working.

Home based programmes

These may be described as assistance given to an individual after identification and assessment, at home and/or in school. This could be as a result of failure to gain school placement immediately and/or poor performance in specific subject areas. For a learner to be included in class, it is recommended that the learner should have acquired some basic skills like toileting, social skills and personal hygiene.

Different professionals will be required to provide relevant assistance in the child's home environment. Physiotherapists, speech therapists, social workers, among others may need to support the learner before admission into an inclusive class.



Home based programmes may be supported by assessment teachers, subject/class teachers, nurses, social workers, and paramedics like physiotherapists among others.

Parents should be able to:-

- assist their children with home work;
- liaise with the teachers to extend their training especially in feeding; toileting and grooming at home;

- ensure that the children spend their leisure time appropriately for example taking them out for excursion over the weekend;

- ensure that toys and other play materials that are meant to promote learning are provided for the learner at home;
- have the knowledge of educational needs of their children and appropriate ways of identifying and providing for them;
- give information about their children's special needs because they are the best experts of their children while teachers are experts on education.
- reinforce the child for example, by buying him toys or allow him to spend time with friends.



You will learn more about home based programmes in Module 13: Introduction to Special Needs; Assessment and Early Intervention.



Summary

You have now come to the end of Unit 2. In this Unit, you have learnt that:

The main components that may enhance inclusive education include the school factors consisting of classroom, the student, the teacher and the teaching methods and the curriculum factors.

You have also covered the support services and resources factor which include resource room, itinerant/peripatetic teacher service, educational resources, parental support, technical support, teacher aide support, peer support, physiotherapy, occupational therapy, guidance and counselling, community support and equipment needed. In an inclusive class, collaboration and consultation are crucial because professional input is a must for success of inclusive education.

The other aspect you have covered in this section is the collaboration and community involvement. These include parental involvement, community involvement, partnership and networking, school management and home based programmes.

This reflects the traditional African outlook whereby societies used to be very inclusive such that each member of a community knew the role to play towards the success of the society (Koech Report 1999). Likewise for inclusive education to take shape, each party involved should play its role.

You also learnt that:

- classrooms can be made more inclusive by planning the learning experience with learner's abilities in mind, marking records for each learner, organizing space to cater for all learners' physical needs and establishing roles for all among other things.
- every student needs to be considered as an individual and the teacher needs to understand their learning styles.

- the classroom teacher is the most important resource in inclusive education and his positive attitude to learners with special needs makes others to accept them.
- the curriculum for regular education needs to be modified to suit the learning needs and capabilities of learners with special needs.

Now you may attempt the following self-test to evaluate your understanding of the Unit.



Self test 2

Answer ALL Questions

1. Kimosi is a learner in your class who has been brought from Makono School for the Blind. List what you and the class can do to assist him to learn effectively in your class *(3 marks)*
2. For inclusive education to work, suggest any four teaching methods that should be used to make learning accessible to all including those with disabilities in your school. *(2 marks)*
3. What are some of the educational resources you may recommend for a resource room? *(2 marks)*
4. How would you involve the parents of learners with special needs in providing effective education to the learners in your class? *(3 marks)*

Score Board

9 - 10	- Very Good	
7 - 8	- Good	
5 - 6	- Satisfactory	
0 - 4	- Read the Unit again	



Learners Outcomes

You have now completed unit 2. The learning outcomes are listed below. Put a tick in the column, which reflects your understanding.

No.	Self evaluation	Sure	Not Sure
1	I can explain the school factors that can facilitate inclusive practice for learners with special needs		
2	I can discuss the support services and the resources that promote inclusive education.		
3	I can now describe why collaboration and community involvement is important for the success of inclusive education.		

If you have put a tick at the not sure column, please go back and study that section in the unit. If you are sure, proceed to the next unit.

You have now come to the end of this unit.



Congratulations!

Well Done. You can now proceed to Unit 3.

Unit 3

Inclusion of learners with special needs

Introduction

Welcome to Unit 3. In this unit, you will learn about the issues in the school and community that you need to address to enable learners with diversity of needs to be included in education and social activities.

Aim

The unit intends to equip you with knowledge, skills and attitudes that will assist you to cater for learners with special needs and disabilities in your class and the community.



Objectives

By the end of this unit, you should be able to:

- describe the basic school requirements that will facilitate inclusion.
- discuss what the general community requires to include learners with special needs and disabilities.
- explain strategies for addressing special needs and disabilities in inclusive education.
- explain why a learner with special needs should participate in the pre-school programme.

The Unit is divided into four sections namely:

Section 1: A School for All

Section 2: Inclusive Community

Section 3: Learning requirements for learners with Special Needs

Section 4: Early Childhood Development and Education for Learners with Special Needs.

Section I: A School for All

There is need to create a school for all by carrying out some reforms with a view to accommodating learners with diversity of special educational needs. The following are some important issues to consider in order to have a smooth implementation of inclusive education:

- policy and registration
- educational resources
- attitude change
- teacher learner ratio
- environmental modification
- teacher training
- teaching and learning strategies

Let us discuss these briefly:-

Policy and Legislation



What is a policy?

A policy is a statement of commitment or official guidelines given by the government to undertake specific programmes directed at achieving some goals. It gives notice to the citizens that new, revised or accelerated programmes of action on a particular issue are intended within a given time frame. Policies are also important at the local school, church or home.

A clear inclusive education policy is important to form a basis for making laws or legislation for the practice to be in place in the country, school or classroom. Countries which have succeeded in inclusive education such as Britain have concrete and clear policies to guide the implementation of inclusive education.

Some international policies on inclusive education include the:

- Declaration of Human Rights – including the right to education and full participation for all people in the society (UN 1948).
- Convention on the Rights of the Child emphasizing education as a fundamental need for all (UN published in 1991).
- Jomtien declaration on education for all (1990). It presented the main goals of
 - Taking all children to school
 - Giving all the children the most suitable education.
- Salamanca statement made at the world Conference on Special Needs Education, Spain of (1994) and final report of (1995).
- Standard Rules on Equalization of Opportunities for Persons with Special Needs including those with Disabilities (UN published 1994).
- Dakar framework for Action – (2000) among others.

National Policies for Inclusive Education.

Among the commissions which the Kenya government has established to look into sustainability of the educational provision for all children are:

- Ngala Mwendwa (1964) – Committee on the Care and Rehabilitation of the Disabled (1964) – put emphasis on the care and rehabilitation of persons with disabilities in all aspects of life.
- The Kenya Education Commission (1964) - Ominde Report – which recommended that children with mild disabilities should continue learning in regular schools. Teachers were asked to be sympathetic to these learners. It also recommended special training to enable teachers to work with them.

- The National Committee on Educational Objectives and Policies (1976) - Gachathi report. It emphasised the importance of improving education and other relevant services for persons with disabilities both in school and community.
- The Presidential Working Party on Education and Manpower Training for the Next Decade and Beyond (1988), Kamunge Report. It emphasised the need for integration of learners with special needs in the regular school. It also investigated specific categories of learners with special needs and recommended on how to meet their needs accordingly.
- Total Integrated Quality Education and Training (TIQET -1999)- Koech Report. It called for equal treatment of the unequals. It advocated for a flexible education system and in particular the curriculum content so as to benefit all learners.
- Children's Act (2001) emphasizes the rights of the child including the right to education.
- Persons with Disabilities Act (2003) – emphasizes the rights of persons with disabilities and inclusion is top of the agenda.
- Report of the Task Force on special Needs, Education (2003) that made for teaching, recommendations including the funding of special units, schools and EARCs.
- Sessional Paper No. 1 of (2005) - Recommends the relevant machineries/ systems to be put in place for the implementation of inclusive education. In order to realise the recommendations of the Sessional paper, the Ministry of Education has developed the Kenya Education Sector Support Programme (KESSP) (2005) document which aims at providing quality lifelong education and training for all Kenyans.

The Kenya Education Act (1968) is currently under review and it is expected to address issues regarding special needs education.



Think of three specific policies in your school or classroom and discuss how it gives direction to the teachers and learners.

I hope you suggested the following among others:

- all school fees and other levies must be paid by the end of the first week of the term in the first year.
- learners are expected to be in full school uniform at all times.
- all parents should attend parents/teachers meetings.
- use of English language at all times.
- all learners must attend Physical Education lessons
- admission age to class one is six years.

For inclusive Education to succeed, educational policies at all levels should stress that a child with special needs should attend the neighbourhood schools with provision of appropriate support services and assistive devices. The needs for flexibility in the curriculum delivery and evaluation should be spelt out in an inclusive education policy.

Policies may not be quite binding unless they are backed by legislation. There is therefore need for stakeholders to impress on the government to formulate and initiate relevant laws to support inclusive education in the country. Learners should be involved in decision making on their learning as much as possible at the school level.



Does Kenya have a policy on Inclusive education?

Kenya does not have a clear policy on special or inclusive education, but the country depends on educational Commissions since independence as cited above and other policy documents. These include the following: Sessional papers such

as No. 6 of (1988) and No.1 of (2005) a draft on policy of special needs education (1988), and others like the KANU manifesto of (1965).

However, it is worthwhile to note that currently, the Ministry of Education is developing a policy on special needs education. The government, however, continues to support learners with special needs including those with disabilities both in regular and special institutions.



To what extent is Kenya Prepared to achieve education for all by the year 2015?

You may be aware of the EFA goals that are set to be realised by the year 2015. You need to be aware also that the Kenya government has put all mechanisms in place ‘through the Kenya Education Sector Support Programme (KESSP) document to help realise these EFA goals. One of these is to have at least one trained teacher in each public primary school.

Educational Resources



Refer to Unit 2 section 2 for information on educational resources.

Attitude Change



What is attitude?

You may simply define attitude as opinion beliefs or feeling about something or people based on experience or and cultural practices about a group of those people. For example, one may form an opinion about the abilities of persons with special needs.

According to Smith (1998), attitude usually depends on the social context concerning particular groups of people such as the mentally disabled or even situations and trends in society generally. Inequality in a community are facts of life. There is need to understand the scientific causes of special needs and also implications for people with disabilities. As such attitudes may not necessarily be reduced to negative attitudes towards persons with special needs.



You are now a special needs education teacher. You have a duty to sensitise other teachers, pupils and school community at large for the purpose of enhancing inclusive education.

Teacher: Learner ratio

Based on your experience, you may have realized that teacher Learner ratio has always been raised in relation to poor academic performance in the schools. Most of the teachers view special needs education in terms of having a lower number of pupils in the class. The teacher ratio in Kenya is 1:50. This is contrary to the Western world where the ratio is as low as 1: 15 or less. Implementing inclusive education is difficult considering the large numbers. However, you are encouraged to put your optimal input as has been discussed on this unit for the success of all learners.

Environmental modification

In order to create a school for all, you will need to ensure that the physical environment is modified to facilitate mobility for all learners. This will enable them to attend to lessons and co-curricular activities. Some essential areas that may require modification include the following:

- the classroom,
- playfields,
- footpaths,
- verandas,
- toilets, latrines or washroom facilities.

All the above areas should be made accessible and friendly for all learners. They should actually be barrier free.



How can you assist to create a barrier – free environment in the areas mentioned above in your school using the available funds?

I hope you have mentioned the following:

- erect supportive handrails for learners with physical or sensory disabilities.
- paint walls with pleasant bright but non glaring colours and surfaces to facilitate effective use of the senses .
- reduce noise and vibration distractions by using noise absorbing materials on classroom walls.
- provide large windows and enough ventilation for more natural light in classrooms and halls.
- provide footpath markers and label significant sections of the school compound for easy identification by learners with special needs.
- level all grounds.

Teacher training

Teacher training is a pre-requisite for the inclusion of learners in the regular school. The government in collaboration with other stakeholders has a great responsibility of training and in-servicing teachers. There is need that appropriate attitudes, skills and competencies are developed in teachers during the years of training.



The practice of inclusion means substantial changes to teaching. As a teachers working with learners with various needs you should have basic knowledge related to attending to the diverse needs of children.

Specialist training to be developed after general teacher training as is the practice in Kenya. This facilitates you to understand the nature of learners with special needs because of the past experiences with regular learners. However, it should change the clinical rehabilitative approach that has dominated the thinking of delivery to children with special needs. In- service training should be centred on the school as a whole so that significant changes in the school culture may be realised.

Teaching and Learning Strategies

Learners with special needs including those with various disabilities will require more refined teaching approaches. These will be tailor made to meet their varying needs.

It is important that you should adapt the teaching methods to include all your learners in the teaching and learning activities. You will learn more about specific teaching approaches in Module 16: Teaching and Learning Strategies for Learners with Special Needs.

Section 2: Inclusive Community

Inclusion of all learners in education can only be successful in a community that embraces inclusion in all aspects of community activities.

Below is a list of essential elements that are prerequisite to promoting an inclusive community:

- advocacy
- attitude
- community sensitization
- environmental accessibility
- support services

Let us explain each of them

Advocacy



What is meant by advocacy?

Advocacy means giving public support to an idea or a course of action or belief (Oxford Learners' Dictionary 2002). You will realise that it is a consistent involvement of persons with disabilities and their organizations in defining for themselves the goals and processes that they want to participate in. Through advocacy, discriminative practices and policies are eliminated.

For example, by developing resource rooms in mainstream schools, St Lucia Blind Welfare Association in the Caribbean Islands demonstrated to the government how teachers for children who are blind could prepare the children,

produce braille and large print versions of textbooks. They challenged the government to set up resource rooms throughout the island.

Thus, such groups including parents for children with disabilities and organizations for persons with disabilities among others can act as catalyst for change.



What areas can you advocate for better service provision to learners with special needs in your school?

I hope you have mentioned the following:

- Staffing of schools with the required number of teachers.
- mobilizing of more school funds to provide learning materials.
- Sensitizing of other learners, teachers, parents and the larger community to be more receptive and accommodative to learners with special needs.
- Sensitizing the school administration to avail funds for environmental modification to make it more accessible to all learners.

Attitudes

You may have realized that there are stereotypic attitudes towards inclusion, disabilities and special needs in various cultures.

Some of these include the following:

- persons with mental disabilities are inhabited by evil spirits which can be passed on to others.
- inclusion is costly
- implementing inclusion needs societal change in attitudes first.
- inclusion is a good theory but is not practical.
- inclusion requires special skills which are difficult to develop.

- inclusion is the responsibility of the Ministry of Culture and Social Services not Education.
- inclusion is about disabilities.
- children with disabilities cannot perform
- children from poor or low socio economic status cannot perform well
- slow learners will never make it
- it's a waste of resources to educate girls.

You can add more to the list.



Refer to Section 1 of this Unit to remind yourself of the attitude changes that can promote inclusion in the school or the larger community.

Community sensitization

You need to remember that communities can hold teachers, administrators and government officials accountable for inclusion of all learners. This may be done through formal mechanisms. This leads to community members becoming more interested in school improvement and more willing to commit their own resources to the task.



How can you sensitize your local community to support inclusion?

You can do this by:

- sharing knowledge and skills on special needs and disabilities highlighting their nature and causes so as to remove stigmatization.

- holding awareness seminars for local leaders on the current trends in educational provisions.
- sharing knowledge on policy and legal developments that positively impact on children's rights to community and public services.
- mobilizing of community resources to serve persons with special needs by appealing for contributions of funds, to support inclusion.
- mobilizing community members to work as volunteers in various inclusive programmes.
- appealing to the community to provide facilities for activities related to inclusive education.

Accessibility to environment

As you learnt in Module 4 : Introduction to Educational Resources I – Theory, it is crucial for effective learning and development that a child learns and operates in a barrier – free environment.

Physical and social barriers need to be identified and removed in:

- the home
- school
- public transport
- public facilities
- physical surroundings



Think of various physical and social barriers that may hinder progress for a learner with special needs in the environment.



Discuss the list with a colleague.

Support services in the community

As discussed in Unit 2 of this module, all learners including those with special needs require to be supported by all in the school as well as the larger community.



What is meant by support services in inclusive education?

In inclusive education, support services include everything that promotes learning particularly those resources that supplement what the ordinary class teacher can provide.

In addition to the support services mentioned earlier, the other support services that need to be organized in the school and the community may include the following among others:

- local resources existing in and around the school trained and brought together to support learners with special needs.
- sensitized children supporting their peers with special needs in and out of school.
- trained teachers of special needs supporting other teachers.
- mobilize parents to act as partners in the education of their children.
- collaborate with other specialists and professionals to support learners with special needs.

Section 3 : Learning Requirements for Learners with Special Needs in Education

Learners with special needs come in various diversities. Most of these learners

can be found in your regular school as you learnt in Module 1: Introduction to children with Special Needs



Discuss with a colleague the various diversities of needs that you may need to address among learners that require your special attention in school.

You may need to address the following diversities:

- learners with visual impairments.
- learners with hearing impairments.
- learners with physical disabilities.
- learners with emotional and behavioural difficulties.
- learners who are gifted and talented.
- learners with specific learning difficulties.
- learners with communication difficulties.
- learners with mental disabilities.

You will be expected to address their diverse needs to promote their inclusion and hence learning.

Let us discuss these briefly.

Learners with Visual Impairments (VI)



Who are learners with visual impairments?

In Module 1: Introduction to Children with Special Needs you were introduced to children with visual impairments. You also learnt about the definition, causes and implications of visual impairments on learning and development as well as characteristics of children with visual impairments. You remember that they can either be termed as blind or having low vision depending on the quality and quantity of remaining vision.

In this section, we are going to discuss what you need to do for a learner with visual impairments to learn effectively in an inclusive classroom.



What does a learner with visual impairment need for learning?

Below is a list of the basic requirements for a learner with visual impairments:

- braille
- low vision devices
- tactile materials
- environmental modifications
- appropriate teaching learning strategies.

Let us discuss each of these one by one.

Braille



What is Braille?

This is a mode of communication that uses embossed or raised characters in different combinations of six dots arranged in a cell, which is two dots wide and three dots high, as shown in fig. 3.1

1 . . 4
2 . . 5
3 . . 6

Figure 3.1: A Braille cell with 6 dots

The learner uses fingers to read the various dot arrangements and writes them using a braille or stylus and frame which you learnt about in Module 4 : Introduction to educational Resources. The six dots form letters, words, punctuations, abbreviations and all language elements that are necessary for learning all subjects.



How can you provide braille services to a learner with visual impairment in your class?

As a teacher for learners with special needs, you should be able to:

- introduce braille skills as early as possible to a learner who has attained reading/writing readiness to enable him/her to develop accuracy and efficiency.

- liaise with the resource room or itinerant teacher in your area to support you and the learner.

Low vision Devices

Again, you learnt in module 1 about those learners with visual impairment but have sufficient vision which can enable them to perform visual tasks with or without vision aids or devices. These aids are referred to as low vision devices.



Discuss with a colleague any low vision devices that may be used to enhance vision and learning.

I hope you mentioned the following:

- optical devices • non-optical devices
- electronic devices.

Let us discuss each of these briefly

Optical devices

These have a lens placed between the object and the eye and provide magnification. They include:

- hand held magnifiers,
- stand magnifiers,
- spectacles mounted magnifiers,
- telescopes.

You can see examples of the optical devices in the diagrammes below:

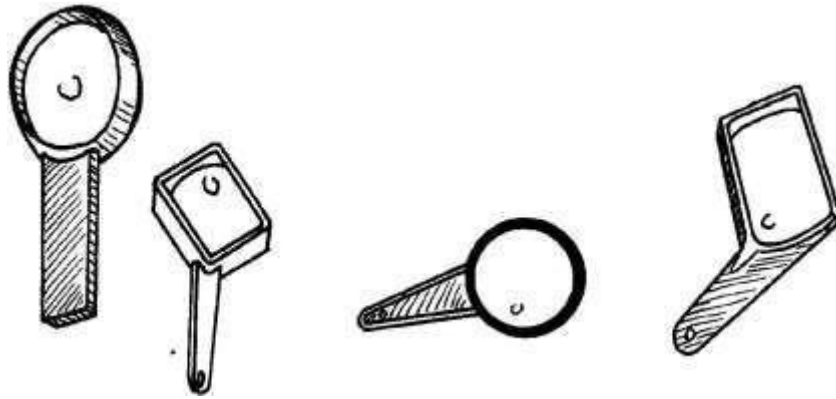


Figure 3.2. (i) Hand-held magnifier



Figure 3.2. (ii) Stand magnifier



Figure 3.2. (iii) Spect

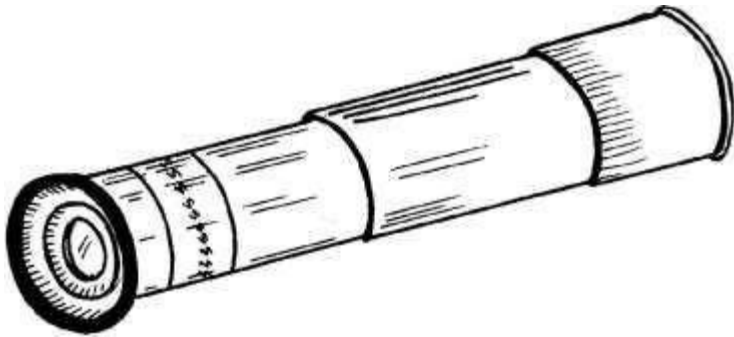


Figure 3.2. (v) Telescope

Non – optical devices

As opposed to optical devices you will note that non-optical devices do not have lenses hence do not provide magnification. They include the following:

- book/reading stands
- large print books
- bold line paper
- lamps
- page markers
- sunglasses among others

Electronic devices

These include the Closed Circuit Television (CCTV). It is an equipment with a large screen and reading platform on which reading materials are placed. Size of the print, lighting and contrast can be adjusted to fit the visual needs of a particular learner.



Visit the nearest Resource Centre in a School/Unit for Learners with visual impairment and identify the low vision devices. Classify them and discuss their use with the resource room teacher.



How do you assist learners with low vision in your class?

I hope you have mentioned the following ways among others.

- guiding them on proper use, maintenance and storage of the low vision devices.
- reminding the learners to attend check-up and follow-up appointments.
- sending them for regular assessment to review visual status.
- Seating them appropriately in class depending on visual needs.
- treating them as individuals and considering their visual needs as advised by the eye doctor.

Tactile materials

As you are aware, all human beings perceive information from their environment through the “five common senses” that include sight, hearing, touch, taste and smell.



Discuss with a colleague the biological terms used to refer to the senses mentioned above.

In the absence or inadequacy of the sense of sight, the learner with visual impairments has to depend on the other remaining senses particularly the auditory and the tactile senses for perception and concept development.



What principles will guide you to plan your teaching instructions to benefit a learner with visual impairments?

I hope you mentioned the following principles:

- Need for concrete experiences

A learner with visual impairments requires hands on experiences to feel and manipulate objects and learning materials in the environment. In other words, the learner experiences tactually while your other learners observe visually. This tactile experience enables him to understand concepts such as shape, size, weight, texture, temperature and so on.

- Unifying experiences

Through vision, one views the totality of objects and develops relationships. The learner with visual impairment therefore needs to be given opportunity to experience situations in their totality to be able to unify past experiences into meaningful wholes.

- Learning by doing

Children who are blind have less opportunity for self initiated activities. They need special attention and encouragement both at home and school to perform tasks for themselves as much as possible.



Discuss with a colleague tactile materials you can use to teach about triangles to a learner who is blind.

Environmental Modification

Learners with visual impairments have the same desire like any other to participate actively in the class, school and community activities.

There is need for some adaptations to be made in their learning and social environment to enhance their movement and operations.

In environmental modification and adaptations you may need to consider the following factors:

- visual acuity or clarity of vision of the learner.
- visual abilities of the individual

- interests and capabilities of the individual
- natural abilities of the individual
- size of the classroom/space in which the individual operates.



What environmental aspects can you adapt for the learner with visual impairment?

You may need to adapt the following environmental aspects to suit the learner with visual impairment:

- lighting depending on the individual learner's needs
- classroom design and arrangement to provide adequate space for movement

- colour and colour contrast appropriately adjusted to suit individual needs • material development, presentation and use in appropriate size and details
- auditory environment to enhance the use of auditory sense.

Teaching and Learning Strategies

When you teach learners with visual impairments you need to consider the unique needs of each individual. It is important that you:

- ask the learner if assistance is needed
- do not assume that all tasks require modifications
- include learners with Visual Impairment in all activities in the class
- use seating arrangements that take advantage of any vision the child may have.
- remember the learner with visual impairment may have normal health and intelligence which should be utilized optimally.



What other teaching strategies do you need to use when working with learners who are visually impaired?

To be able to

teach the learner with visual impairments in the regular class effectively, you will need to:

- call the student by name and speak directly to him.
- take breaks at regular intervals to minimize fatigue

- allow the learner choose the best seating position in order to utilize remaining senses including vision.

- vary type of instructions and include hands-on activities, cooperative learning or the use of real life materials.
- use high contrast materials
- use large print materials only after assessment of learners with visual needs.
- teach the learner with visual impairment to communicate non verbally through gestures and facial expressions
- work with the learner to eliminate inappropriate mannerisms
- assign a classmate to assist the learner who needs help without being too dependent on others
- inform all concerned in advance of the learner with visual impairment in case of a field trip or excursion.

Specialized Equipment

For you to teach learners with visual impairments in an inclusive class effectively, you will need the following materials and equipment.

- talking books - these are books, cards and magazines recorded in tapes.
- braille machines for writing.
- slate and stylus for writing Braille.
- tape recorders for recording lessons and other information.
- typewriter for communication with sighted teachers and other learners.
- computer for communication with speech synthesisers and appropriate software programme.
- talking calculators – with voice output.

- optacon – for scanning printed material and transforming it into raised dots that can be read with fingertips
- braille embosser – computer printer that produces materials from the computer in braille. (This may be provided for in a resource room).

Learners with Hearing Impairments (HI)



Who are learners with Hearing Impairment?

I hope you remember that these are learners who experience difficulties with their hearing which could be mild or severe. They are categorized as hard of Hearing or deaf of Hearing respectively.



How can you create an inclusive school environment for learners with hearing impairment?

You can create inclusive school environments for learners with hearing impairment by doing the following:

- adapting the use of a variety of communication modes.
- modifying the classroom appropriately
- availing audiological equipment and devices
- adapting appropriate teaching and learning strategies.

Let us now look at each of these:

Modes of communication



What are the different modes of communication?

I hope you mentioned the following:

- manual communication • total communication and
- aural/oral methods.

Let us now discuss each of them.

The manual method.

This mode of communication is made up of two elements:

- sign language for example the Kenyan sign language whereby a set of signs is used to represent words or concepts.
- finger spelling which is achieved by use of the manual alphabet. It usually serves as a supplement to sign language because if there is no sign for a word, it is spelt out. Usually it is used for proper names and in situations where a person is not sure of the sign for a particular word.



Visit the nearest school/unit for learners with hearing impairment and observe how they communicate using the manual method. Compare your findings with a colleague.

The Aural/Oral Method

This approach emphasizes the development of speech/lip reading. It leads to the inclusion of people who are deaf in the larger society. The oral approach focuses on the use of residual hearing and speech training.

Total communication

Total communication gives the child with hearing impairment the right to use all forms of communication. Total communication includes the full spectrum of language modes such as: gestures, sign language, spoken language, speech reading, finger spelling, reading and writing among other modes of communication. This philosophy gives the child an opportunity to develop residual hearing by using aids and/or other amplification systems.



Suggest how you would use total communication to teach the topic “uses of water” to learners including one with hearing impairment.

Classroom modification

You may find that you have a learner with hearing impairment in your classroom. You may assist such a learner in the following ways:

- provide preferential sitting position in the class for example, in front of the class, away from vibrations and distractions such as animal

and traffic sounds. This is particularly so if one of the child's ear is better than the other.

- give the child opportunities to speak in class just as you do to others.
- rephrase a question or statement if the child does not seem to understand.

- repeat a statement or question if not understood initially.
- stress the importance of clear pronunciation to all learners in the class.
- make sure you have eye contact as you speak to the learner with hearing impairment.
- consider using a hearing learner to help the learner with hearing impairment with activities that heavily depend on hearing.
- always remember that a learner with hearing impairment may become fatigued more quickly than others. This is because they work harder at hearing and concentrating on watching your face.
- treat the classroom acoustically by using materials that absorb sound.

Audiological equipment and devices

It is important for you to understand that the hearing impairment of a learner may be improved by use of audiological equipment and devices. This is particularly so for those with residual hearing.



What are audiological equipment and devices?

I hope you mentioned that these are aids which amplify sound and/or improve the hearing conditions for the learner.



How can you improve the learners' physical conditions for effective hearing?

I hope you mentioned that there are three ways in which physical conditions for effective hearing can be improved. This can be done through:

- better acoustic conditions
- using hearing aids
- cochlea implant

Let us briefly discuss each of them.

Better acoustic conditions

These can be created in the classroom environment. If a room has a carpet, curtains, wood, reed and soft furnishings, the amount of background noise will be reduced. This will make it easier for a learner with moderate hearing loss to detect sound signals they need to hear.

Using Individual Hearing Aids (IHAS)

Children with hearing impairment can be helped by wearing hearing aids. A hearing aid amplifies sound enabling the learner to hear better.

A hearing aid comprises of:

- battery that powers the system.
- microphone for picking up sound
- amplifier for increasing the volume
- receiver for delivering the intensified sound to the ear as illustrated in figure 3.3(i)

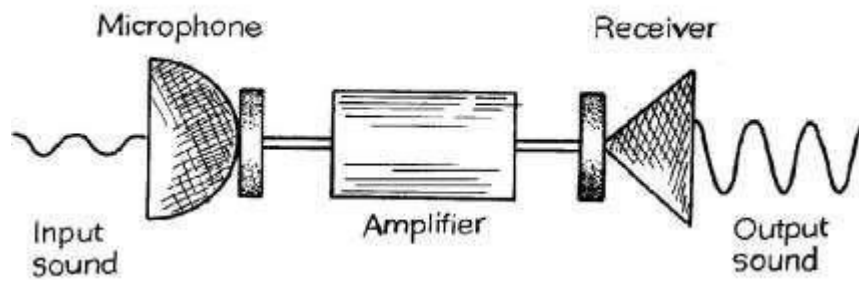


Figure 3.3: (i) Basic structure of Hearing Aid.

Adopted from Smith (1998)

There are a variety of hearing aids such as:

- the body worn model.
- the behind the ear model
- the all in the ear model
- hearing aids built into the frames of glasses model

For more clarification, you can look at the diagrams in figure 3.3 (ii).



Visit a school or unit for learners who are hearing impaired and find out, the different types of hearing aids used by the learners.

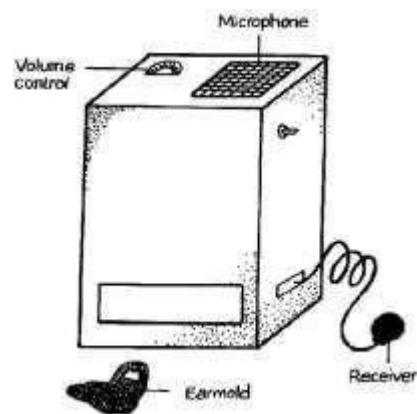


Fig 3.3 (ii) The body worn model

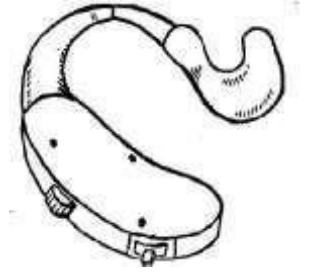


Figure 3.3 (iii) The behind the ear model.

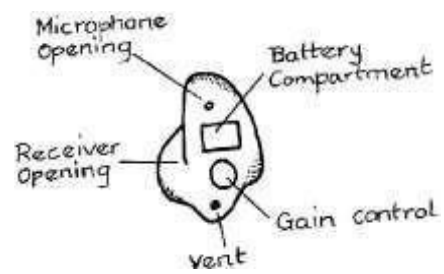


Fig 3.3 (iv) The all in the ear model.

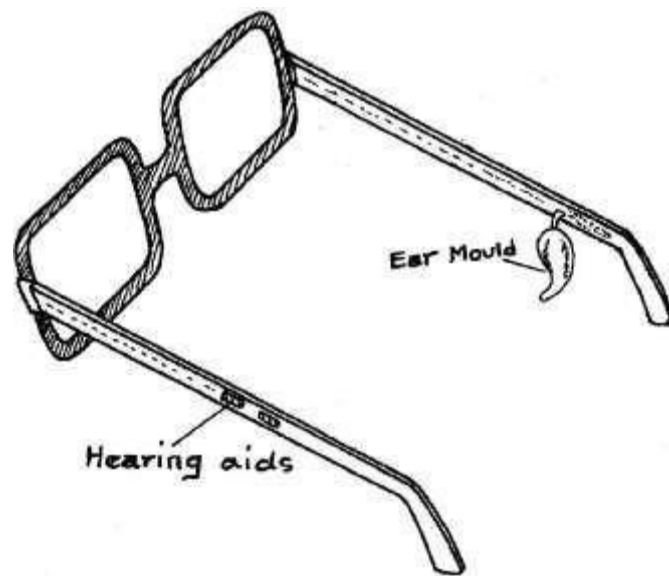


Fig 3.3. (v) Hearing aids built into the frames of glasses model.

Other amplification equipment: These include frequency Modulated System (FMS) that is used by learners with hearing losses. It is a wireless system that transmits the teacher's voice through a microphone worn by the teacher directly to a receiver worn by the learner. The frequency modulated signal is more intense and clearer than the amplification provided by individual hearing aids.



Discuss with a colleague the differences that you noticed in the hearing aids

Cochlea implant: This is the newest way of improving the physical conditions for hearing that can be fitted surgically to learners with profound impairment. Normally such learners cannot be helped by conventional hearing aids.

A cochlea implant is a device that is surgically implanted in the inner ear by passing the damaged area. Sounds picked up by an external microphone are transmitted directly to an electrode in the cochlea stimulating the nerve of hearing directly. Cochlea implants may be particularly useful to learners who are unable to use amplification because of the nature of their hearing loss.



Hearing aids/devices are fitted by audiologists who are able to select the most suitable and appropriate ones based on audiological examination.

Teaching and Learning Strategies

You may use one or a combination of the following teaching methods with learners who are hearing impaired.

- dramatization
- demonstration
- chld-to-child • other method.

Let us look at the features of these briefly.

Dramatization

This is a situation where you provide opportunities for your learner to act out a learning experience. It is an appropriate method because it:

- builds confidence and self esteem
- motivation learners
- encourages active participation of learners • reinforces memory.
- promotes team work, co-operation, imagination.
- develops the learner's talents.
- develops the learners socially, morally, intellectually and physically.

Demonstration

Demonstration is another learning situation where you may use the learner to perform a given task as others watch. Among other things, demonstration:

- reinforces memory in learners.
- stimulates learning
- makes learning real
- motivates learners.
- builds confidence in learners.
- encourages the use of teaching/learning resources

Child to child

You will notice that in an inclusive classroom, you have learners with diverse abilities. You may therefore pair two learners so that one assists the other in various learning tasks. This method helps to:

- reinforce learning by children helping one another.
- builds co-operation among children, sharing and turn taking.

- build confidence in children
- enhance normalisation of children with hearing impairments through social

interaction.

Other methods that you may also use with learners who are hearing impaired include:

- projects
- questioning and answering
- micro teaching
- peer tutoring
- team teaching
- child centred approaches
- teacher centred approaches
- remedial teaching
- excursions
- mediated learning experiences

You will learn more about teaching and learning methods in Module 16: Teaching and Learning strategies.



Select a teaching method and discuss with a colleague its advantages and disadvantages.

Let us now consider adjustments within the teacher.



What can you do in order to accommodate a learners who may rely on speech reading as a means for receptive language?

Always remember that learners with hearing impairment require the best view possible for your mouth and facial expressions. They depend heavily on ‘seeing’ what you are saying.

Therefore as a teacher you should always remember to:

-
- avoid moving about as you are talking to them.
 - Stand where there is adequate light.

- make sure there is no glare of light in the eyes of the learner with hearing impairment
- do not cover your mouth while talking.
- face the learners while explaining materials from the chalkboard or any other visual aid.
- do not keep a moustache as it makes speech reading difficult.
- avoid excessive mouthing.
- try to speak naturally and a little bit slower than normal.



You are encouraged to mention any other rule that you may need to observe as a teacher

Teaching Learners who have Physical Disabilities



Who are learners with physical disabilities?

As you learnt in Module 1: Introduction to Children with Special Needs, learners with physical disabilities are those with muscular skeletal and neurological impairments. You can classify these learners with physical disabilities into three(3) broad categories namely:

- muscular skeletal impairment
- neurological impairments • other health impairments.

Let us now discuss the conditions associated with each of the categories.

Muscular Skeletal

These are impairments associated with the skeleton and muscles. The conditions associated with impairment of skeleton and muscles include the following among others:-

- scoliosis
- amputations
- osteogenesis imperfecta (brittle bone)
- muscle cramps
- legparthesis disease
- polio-myelitis
- muscular dystrophy.

Neurological condition

This refers to paralysis or dysfunction associated with dysfunction of the brain and nervous system The conditions, associated with neurological impairment include:-

- cerebral palsy
- epilepsy
- poliomyelitis
- spina bifida - hydrocephalus
- microcephalus.

Other Health Impairments These

include:

- Diabetes

-
- Heart diseases

- Sickle cell anaemia

- Asthma
- Tuberculosis.

You learnt about the above stated conditions in Module 1: Introduction children with special needs.



How do physical disabilities and impairments affect learners?

I hope you mentioned the following limitations:-

- use of legs for walking and physical activities
- use of hands for writing, reading and other manual tasks
- use of affected muscles
- movement and balance
- coordination especially the eye – hand
- performance of physical tasks
- school attendance due to frequent absenteeism from class to attend clinic and surgical operations.



How can you assist a learner with physical disabilities to overcome barriers in your class?

You may address the following among others in order to assist learners with physical disabilities in your class.

- environmental accessibility
- adaptation of instructional materials
- teaching/learning strategies

Let us discuss these briefly:

Environmental accessibility

The environmental barriers that you may address in your school to ensure accessibility for learners with physical disabilities may include the following:

- modifying and adapting the school and classroom environment to facilitate free movement such as replacing stairs with ramps.
- adapting the heights of toilet seats for easy use by learners with physical disabilities.
- providing supportive bars along the classroom, halls and toilet doors for learners to stand, walk, sit or move easily
- levelling the grounds and removing obstacles to encourage the learner with physical disabilities to move freely all over the compound.
- widening the verandas and aisles in buildings to allow access for all learners including those using wheelchairs and crutches.
- modifying classroom seating and school assembly arrangements to accommodate the learners with physical disabilities.

Adaptation of instructional materials

Some of the learners with physical disabilities may not use their limbs to perform learning activities. For such learners, you may need to make adaptations in the functional body parts.



What adaptations can you make in your class or learners with physical disabilities?

I hope you mentioned the following material adaptations for your learners with physical disabilities:-

- create room for free movement in the classes
- provide page turners for learners with weak hands to be able to turn pages of books
- avail book holders
- use of adapted chairs to correct body posture
- use of pencil grips
- provide mobility devices such as wheelchairs, walking frames and crutches for movement
- use communication boards and bliss symbols for those with speech problems
- ensure that they wear the corrective appliances all the times.



Refer to Module 4: Introduction to Educational Resources - Theory for further examples of adaptation of instructional materials

Teaching and Learning Strategies

To effectively teach a learner with physical disabilities, it is important that you:

- encourage peers to interact with the learner and assist as they learn;
- adapt the curriculum for the learner to learn at his own pace;
- train the learner to make use of the functional parts of the body for writing and performing other activities;
- help the learner to acquire basic skills for self care and good relations with others;
- train the learner to use mobility devices;
- device alternative modes of communication if the learner has speech difficulties;
- allow extra time for the learner to complete given tasks;
- ensure that the learner maintains a good sitting posture to prevent secondary deformities;

- enlist volunteers such as teacher aides and parents to support the learner in and out of class;
- network with other professionals such as occupational therapists; physiotherapists, and other medical experts to support the learner.



Visit a school with learners who have physical disabilities and investigate the difficulties they encounter in the school.



Discuss with their teachers how they can assist the learners to overcome the difficulties.

Learners with Emotional and Behavioural Difficulties (EBD)

You were introduced to learners with emotional and behavioural difficulties in Module 1: Introduction to Children with Special Needs. Let us now consider how they can be included in the classroom.



Discuss with a colleague the characteristics of learners with emotional and behavioural difficulties.

You need to remember that children with emotional and behavioural difficulties manifest negative emotions and behaviours that is not age appropriate and these do not conform to the social norms. Such children are commonly found in the regular schools.

You need to be familiar with measures that you can take to effectively include them in your teaching. These measures include the following:

- rehabilitation
- social training
- community support
- environmental adjustments
- psychological intervention Let us discuss these briefly.

Rehabilitation of learners with EBD

You should remember that the process of rehabilitation is all about the restoration of good reputation or skills lost through training or treatment. Rehabilitating learners with emotional and behavioural difficulties should be seen as a process. This calls for ample patience and endurance on your part as a teacher.



What can you do to rehabilitate a learner who has started taking alcohol when he/she is in class 4?

You can assist the learner by:

- counselling the learner to realise the effects of drugs.
- ensuring the learner is busy both in and out of class by involving him/ her in social activities like games, sports and recreation
- training the child to ask for permission in case of absenteeism.
- avoiding negative punishment like corporal punishment
- reinforcing good behaviour in and out of class
- training the learner on vocational skills that may be easily sustained

within the community

- providing spiritual care and guidance
- engaging him/her in gardening activities
- taking care of livestock and other domestic animals and pets
- providing good communication skills
- avoiding locking up/restricting such a learner
- avoiding negative language like calling the learner a criminal
- involving parents and the community in the rehabilitation effort

Social Skills training

Learners should be encouraged to develop social skills that play a key role in learning. Teachers may instil positive emotional and behavioural skills in learners by using a program such as skill streaming.



What is skill streaming?

This is a programme that includes the elements named below:

- modelling of positive behaviour by trained learner or teacher.
- role playing where the learner practices the learnt behaviour
- performance feedback where the learner performs to show that the inappropriate behaviour has been overcome
- transfer of training – support different situation in using the newly acquired social skill.

Community Support

The concept of an inclusive community means that communities adapt their structures and procedures to facilitate the inclusion of persons with special needs including disabilities.

The community may work towards minimising physical barriers for example by:

- providing employment for school leavers or dropouts so that they are kept busy;
- providing vocational guidance;
- assisting in family business or community activities such as cleaning up churches or prayer houses;
- consulting the relevant authority when unbecoming behaviour is noticed particularly when learners are going to and from school.

Environmental adjustments



What are the classroom adjustments that you may undertake to accommodate learners with emotional behavioural difficulties in your class?

Learners with emotional and behavioural difficulties should be provided with a structured environment. This implies that you arrange the physical environment, daily events, materials, strategies to be used in teaching and working with the learners appropriately. You can do this by:

- avoiding distracting objects in class
- neatly arranging the classroom to allow for free movement.
- setting a classroom routine that is predictable
- making decisions for learners until such time when they can wisely manage their own behaviour.
- ensuring that learners are made to understand the desirable and undesirable behaviours.



What can you do to minimise distraction in your class?

Some of the hints that you may use to minimise distracting stimuli include the following:

- sound proof by treating the walls and ceilings
- carpeting the floors
- giving clear instructions.
- covering bookshelves and cupboards
- giving a routine with possible positive results
- using translucent material or frosted glass to cover windows.
- decorating items on specified occasions.
- setting and communicating firm expectations
- being consistent in rewarding positive behaviour



Discuss with a colleague other possible ways of avoiding distractive stimuli for learners with emotional difficulties in your class

You should remember that EBD may have resulted from children:

- feeling not loved
- not accepted in family, school or neighbourhood
- with tendency to be suspicious

Such children need assurance that they are accepted as they are. This facilitates their change and hence develop appropriate behaviour, self esteem and trust. You need to empathise with their feelings and experiences and seek to communicate with them in accepting, non judgemental ways. You must develop a bond of trust with them.

As a teacher you need to work in collaboration with other professionals in order to manage the behaviour of learners with EBD. These professionals include:

- psychiatrists;
- psychologists;
- counsellors;
- social workers;
- teachers;
- significant others such as parents, siblings and peers.

Teachers should be involved in the therapeutic teams for learners with EBD. This is because they interact with the learners most of the day and therefore have opportunities to monitor them. Parents should equally be involved. They too know their children well and spend considerable amount of time with them.



What should you do as a teacher incase you detect aspects of emotional and behavioural difficulties in your learners.

Teachers should:

- create good relationships with the learner;
- extend therapeutic activities such as reassuring the learners to feel valued;
- try to establish the root cause of the behaviour;
- Involve the parents and other professionals incase the condition is proving difficult.

However, the teacher may be limited due to:

- inadequate time
- lack of training
- other classroom responsibilities



How can teachers prevent emotional and behavioural problems?

It is important to note that the most effective techniques for dealing with emotional and behavioural problems in the classrooms are those that prevent the problems from occurring. Some suggestions to make the classroom more responsive to learners with emotional behavioural difficulties include the following:

- explaining to the learner what you expect of him in terms of academic activities and acceptable behaviour;
- establishing healthy relationships with the learners;
- recognizing learner's positive attributes, accomplishments and/or achievements for example by positive comments;
- good preparation of the work to be covered;
- developing a classroom that is both physically and socially positive.

Teaching Children who are Gifted and Talented



Which learners are referred to as gifted and talented?

The term gifted and talented refers to a heterogeneous group of learners with exceptional

abilities who display high level of intelligence.

You need to remember that exceptionally high performance may be demonstrated in any or more of the following areas:

- general intellectual ability
- specific academic aptitude
- creative and productive thinking
- leadership ability • visual performing arts
- psychomotor ability.



Refer to Module 1: Introduction to Children with Special Needs and note the characteristics of children who are gifted, talented, and those who are creative. Highlight on their areas of excellence.

I hope you highlighted the following characteristics about those who are gifted.

- they have no problem in going through the school curriculum
- do well academically in institutions of higher learning
- are bright and very intelligent
- may be very good in languages, mathematics or science
- exhibit good leadership skills

For those who are talented, they may do very well in music, fine arts, mechanical work, dancing, singing, athletics or sports just to mention a few.

Finally, I hope you found that those who are creative demonstrate high level of originality or ability to restructure the world. Creative writers and musicians who come up with new ideas fall in this group.



What problems do you think learners who are gifted and talented face?

You must have realised that these children are different from the others in class. They will have their own unique problems with their peers and teachers. Some of the problems include the following:

- due to their high intelligence, these children do not cope well with their peers. They may be unable to develop positive interpersonal relationships. Many of them become withdrawn or loners.
- some teachers find them too challenging and often misinterpret their behaviour as cheekiness or being rude. They are therefore subjected to unmerited punishments.
- they may also engage in some disruptive behaviour in class. This may be because the child finds class work and other activities meant for their age group too easy. He/she will therefore finish the assigned task within a short time and due to boredom and frustration, may engage in disrupting classroom activities.
- such children may also find themselves dominating in group or class discussions to an extent that the others will give little or no contributions at all. This does not augur well with the other learners who may turn against them.

Such children therefore need your protection, care and guidance so as realise optimal potentials.



How can you support a learner who is gifted and talented in your class?

There are several ways that you may use to ensure that these learners are supported in your class. You can:

- enrich their programmes;
- provide them with accelerated programme;
- group them appropriately in class or provide special classes for them;
- enhance their creativity beyond what their peers are doing.

Let us discuss each of the above briefly.

Enrichment of programmes



What do you understand by the term ‘enrichment?’

In education enrichment is the addition of disciplines or areas of learning not normally found in the regular curriculum.

Enrichment experiences allow each learner to investigate topics of interest in depth. Some of these may be completed during classroom time. For example, if you are teaching about the Rift Valley in Social studies in standard five, you can ask the child who is gifted and talented to make a model of the Rift Valley using the knowledge learnt while others are doing regular assignment.

This calls for differentiated programming where learning opportunities provided to the learner are based on his/her needs and abilities. Differentiation can be done in the content, learning process and the final product expected from the learner. The difference lies in the depth, scope, pace and of the teachers expectations of the learner.

Acceleration of programmes/skipping grade



What is ‘acceleration’?

When used in the field of education acceleration is any process that leads to the learner’s more rapid movement through the regular programme of a school. It may include:

- early school entrance
- subject matter acceleration
- grade (class) skipping
- self – paced instruction
- planned completion, for example of three grades in two years
- early advanced placement in college or any other arrangement that leads to a learner’s completion of the regular programme in less than the normally stipulated time.

Ability grouping/special classes

Students of similar ability levels or interests can be grouped together to bring different perspectives in tasks and stimulate the creative thinking of others.

Ability grouping includes the following approaches:

- regular classroom with cluster groups
- regular classroom with pullout arrangements
- individualized classroom
- special class with some integrated classes
- special class

- special school



You can find more about these provisions in Module 1:
Introduction to Children with Special Needs.

Enhancing Creativity

In addition to the intervention strategies discussed above, you may enhance the gifted and talented learners' creativity by:

- varying teaching methods to embrace more problem solving activities.
- including more elaborate, complex and in depth study of major ideas, problems and themes
- urging the learner to explore constantly.
- promoting self - initiated and self-directed learning
- evaluating learners with stress based on their ability to perform at a level of excellence that demonstrates creativity and higher level thinking skills.



Unless you find outlets, these learners may channel their energies and intelligence into unfavourable social habits such as making unnecessary noise in class or even taking drugs

Other approaches that you may use to assist a learner who is gifted and talented include the following:

- analyzing your instructional programme to avoid boredom

- providing special materials and or activities beyond the regular curriculum
- designing enrichment activities which should support the individual in learning to relate and evaluate facts and ideas, to think originally, to work through complex problems and issues and apply understanding to new situations
- giving the learner more responsibilities that are challenging
- being a good role model to the learner
- increasing individual attention
- promoting creativity by stimulating the learner's awareness of the environment
- exposing the learner to a wide range of experiences on a personal level
- acknowledging the learner's work or efforts

Learners with Specific Learning Difficulties (SLD)

You were introduced to learners with specific learning difficulties in Module 1: Introduction to Children with Special Needs. We hope you remember these learners who experience difficulties in one or more skill areas like reading, writing or computation skills.

Let us now look at how you can help these learners by using the following techniques:

- remedial instructions
- cognitive strategies
- behavioral strategies
- perceptual strategies
- teaching and learning strategies
- individualized education programme (IEP)
- task analysis
- classroom adaptation

Remedial Instructions

These are instructions aimed at helping a learner to improve in a concept or skill area that was not fully developed. This could involve skill areas such as:-

- reading
- writing • comprehending
- computation.



When do you give remedial instructions?

You may give remedial instructions during:-

- the lesson by clarifying the skill areas the learner was not able to grasp.
- lunch break where you could spend a few minutes with the learner.
- your free time after classes or before classes.
- sit by the learner who is experiencing difficulties and give him/her the support she/he requires.
- in a group of mixed abilities, assign a peer who is good at the subject, he/she finds difficult, to assist him/her.
- have a co-teacher work with the learner with SLD as you assist the rest of the class.

Cognitive strategies



The material presented to the learner must be meaningful.

You may have realised that children who have problems in memory and attention may not have as large knowledge as many other students. They may experience less background information on which to attach new things learnt. You should therefore ensure that the learner understands the meaning of what is being taught, read or questions about new information. You could do this by using examples, analogies or contrasts.



Discuss with a colleague examples of analogies that you can use when teaching a particular content

You need to provide or give encouraging feedback to the learners. Constant feedback on their performance helps the learners in developing confidence in themselves and their abilities.

You need to place the weak learners in a ‘no failure’ learning context. Learners often experience failure in some of the work they do. It is important to start off the learner at the point where he can do the work without failing. This means in reading for example you may take a learner to a lower grade than the rest of his classmates such as basic letter recognition and then move forward. After mastering the base-line level of mastery of some content the work given should be gradually introduced to ensure success. The learner needs to be taken back to the starting point of their difficulties. They should be given what they need so that they may understand what they missed.

Teach the learner highlighting skills to help with recall. This means encouraging him to highlight or use a marker by selecting headings, key sentences and terms.

Allow memory aids for example by allowing the students to use calculators to do multiplication if the learner has problems in recalling multiplication tables.

Behaviour Strategies

This is a classroom situation where you develop and employ a reward system for your learners to promote learning. The rewards you develop must be familiar with your learners and should be applied consistently and correctly.

In the hierarchy of rewards, you may include the following:

- stars

- tokens
- praises
- free time
- tangible objects such as biscuits, sweets, crayons and markers



What roles do rewards play in Learners experiencing specific Learning Difficulties?

I hope you mentioned the following:

- motivating the learners to complete their learning tasks
- building awareness of self and others • encouraging positive behaviour
- promoting team work.

Perceptual strategies

Learners experiencing specific difficulties in learning may also experience perceptual difficulties. These may include auditory and visual perception difficulties.



How do you help a learner with perceptual difficulties?

You may help a learner with perceptual difficulties by:-

- training him/her to discriminate various shapes, colours and sizes.
- training him/her to discriminate sounds.
- providing exercises that develop skills in sensory analysis. For example, detecting the fine details of a figure or sound.

- providing spatial relation exercises for the learner to feel the different positions of figures and symbols in space.

You will learn more about this in module 16: Teaching and Learning Strategies

Teaching and Learning Strategies

You may need to vary your teaching and learning approaches with different learners to ensure that learning takes place effectively.



What are the general strategies that you can use to support learners with SLD?

I hope you mentioned the following:

- set aside some time each day for daily practice of the skill in question.
You should prepare activities, which suit the ability and needs of every learner in your class, including those with SLDs.
- let the learner do the activities at the normal time of the day with peers
- let the learner with SLDs sit near your table. You can provide support without drawing attention to others.

Individualized Educational Programme (IEP)

You can prepare an individualized educational programme (IEP) for a learner in your class who is experiencing a specific learning difficult.

An IEP is a written statement that describes what the teacher and other professionals will do to meet the special needs of the learner. Ideally an IEP should be developed by a multi-disciplinary team which should consist of:

- the learner's regular teacher

- a special educational needs teacher
- an assessment teacher
- other professionals who may include psychologist, speech therapist, occupational therapist, physiotherapist and social worker if they are available.
- parent



What is the advantage of IEP in an inclusive classroom?

An inclusive classroom has several advantages. These include:

- allowing each learner to pursue learning at his/her own pace.
- allowing the bright learner to accelerate ahead • preventing the slow learner from being pushed.

However you should assume a leading role in designing the IEP using information provided by the members of the team. The IEP should relate to actual performance as observed by teachers and other professionals as well as test results.

An IEP has the following six major components:

- the learners present level of performance.
- long term and short-term instructional objectives.
- evaluation procedure and criteria.
- special needs education and related services.
- implementation.

Let us once again examine these components briefly.

The learners' present level of performance

In deciding what to teach, you have to assess the learners current level of performance to identify those skills the learner has strengths and those he/she has weaknesses (challenges). You can do this through observations, tests or interviews. The assessment may be done through:

- asking learners to read aloud to assess word recognition abilities
- spelling words on a spelling list
- calculating mathematical problems
- reciting the letters of the alphabet
- test records

The results of the tests will indicate the:-

- strength of the learner
- weaknesses of the learner.



Strengths indicate what the learner can do and weaknesses indicate what the learner is not able to do.

From the weaknesses you set long term and short term objectives and then you plan a programme to help the learner to overcome the weaknesses.

Long term Objectives

You derive this from the weaknesses. They are supposed to be covered over a period of time, far after one week, one month or three months depending on learning needs of the learner.

Short term Objectives

You derive this from the long term objectives. They are supposed to be achieved after a short period of time, for example a lesson, or two lessons.

Evaluation Procedures and Criteria

Here you will learn how the progress of the learner will be measured using test tools the and the standards that are to be used.

Implementation

In order to implement an IEP programme, you must indicate when it will start and the length of time it will take and the date it will be terminated.

Task Analysis



What is task analysis?

Task analysis is the process of breaking down a task to be learnt into smaller steps to be presented to the learners in sequence from the simplest to complex. This is important because learning the whole task in a single lesson can be overwhelming to the learners. In using task analysis you should:

- identify the skills to be taught based on the special need and the ability of the learner.
- establish the sequence of instruction.
- define pre-requisite skills needed to master the task.
- record performance and pin point errors.
- understand difficulties associated with the task when learners fail to perform as expected.
- individualise the instructions to meet the learner's ability level.

I hope you included the following:

- determining the terminal goal and present level of functioning.
- identify pre-requisite skills needed to perform the task.
- determine the sub-skills and place them in correct sequence.
- implement instructions.

Classroom Adaptation



Remind yourself what is meant by adaptation as you learnt in the earlier section of this unit

When you are developing classroom adaptation, it is always important to reflect on the diversity of learners with specific learning difficulties as you learnt in Module 1: introduction to children with Special Needs Education. Adaptations may be inclined to accommodate areas like academic and language deficits, social emotional difficulties, attention, memory, cognition, perception and motor skills. This suggests that classroom adaptation depends on the needs of the learner. Some adaptations that you can make in a classroom are suggested as follows:-

- bring the child closer to the blackboard/teacher.
- desk, chair or table should reflect the size of the learner.
- charts should not be hanging too high and not too low .
- consider the eye level of the learner.
- arrange the classroom according to the needs of the learner for example u-shape, round table, neatly arranged rows among others.
- avoid using other colours on the chalkboard. It should be painted black and use white chalk.
- keep the classroom clean.
- classroom should be well ventilated and lighted.
- put ramps at the door for easier mobility.
- charts and any other writing in the classroom should be clean.



Find out in your school what makes some children not master basic skills in language and computation and suggest how you can work with other teachers to help the learners to overcome the problems.

Learners with Communication Difficulties

You were introduced to learners with communication difficulties in Module 1: Introduction to Children with Special Needs. In this section you will learn how learners with communication difficulties may be helped.

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Learners with communication difficulties experience problems either in reception or expressive language.

In order to assist these learners in your classroom you may:

- provide them with communication aids or equipment
- alternative modes of communication
- vary your teaching and learning strategies
- make environmental modification • provide them with special training.

Let us examine these briefly.

Communication Resources



Which resource would you consider to be appropriate for learners with communication difficulties?

I hope you mentioned the following among others:

- communicative boards with pictures, photographs and letters of the alphabet.
- tape recorders
- computer and typewriters.

Alternative Modes of Communication



What are alternative modes communication?

You may realise that learners who are neurologically impaired and are not able to speak require other techniques of communication in place of speech for the purpose of communication. Such techniques are also referred to as alternative modes of communication. These modes include the following:

- communication boards
- pictograms and ideograms
- bliss symbols
- sign supported speech
- audio-visual materials
- signs
- gestures



Refer to Module 4: Introduction to Education Resources – Theory to remind you on how most of these resources are made.

Sign Supported Speech

This is an approach where spoken language and manual communication is used simultaneously, that is, signing and finger spelling is executed. This communication is based on the structure of the spoken language the signs following most of the spoken words are thus believed to be there to help the speed and ease of lip-reading and understanding of the spoken language. The person using this method speaks, finger-spells and signs every word in logical and correct English word order which may also be described as Signed Exact English. In an inclusive class this may be necessary to learners who have communication difficulties stemming from hearing impairment.

Teaching and learning strategies

As you are already aware, learners with communication difficulties may have problems with receptive or expressive language.

The aim of intervention should be functional communication that is, you should aim at assisting the child to be able to express self and understand others. Functional communication, therefore, emphasises the acquisition of communication skills that can enable a learner to do such tasks as:

- expression of needs
- asking questions



On the whole, we are not concerned about perfectly pronounced grammatical speech but being able to get the message across and to understand others.

There are many approaches to language intervention. Generally, the most ideal approach is to intervene considering the child's functioning level compared to normally developing children. This is the developmental approach which works best for the majority of children with communication difficulties especially those with delayed language.



Which are the areas of language requiring interventions?

The areas of language requiring intervention include the following:

- attention

- listening for understanding
- turn-taking
- ability to express self
- use of body language



All these skills develop slowly from birth over a period of time and they are dependent on each other. None of the skill develops in isolation

In a language intervention programme, therefore, the skills are developed simultaneously in natural situations.

Let us examine how you can train the learner to acquire:

- train learner to pay attention by listening and speaking in that order.
- train the learner to listen for understanding.

This is the ability to listen carefully to sounds, words, sentences and their intention in order to understand their meaning. The development of listening skills starts soon after birth when the child becomes aware of different environmental sounds such as a dog barking, a door opening or somebody calling out the child's name.

- assist a child to acquire turn taking skills by providing opportunities that will encourage the child to respond such as taking turns in a game and play.

Imitating actions such as rolling or throwing a ball, banging on a ball and vocalization

- train the child to express self by giving him plenty of opportunities to express himself.

You should also understand what the child is trying to say, ask him/her questions about it, then respond accordingly.

- train the learner to use body language in communication such as gestures, facial expressions and hand movements. Interpret the body language correctly and respond.



How can we support learners with language difficulties to acquire language?

I hope you mentioned the following ways where you involve the learner.

- household chores and errands in talk to the child about what you are doing.
- play with parents, siblings and peers
- language games e.g. story telling
- social interactions in the family and community such as church service and weddings, among other activities
- songs and poems
- tongue twisters
- riddles

To improve learners' language skills the teacher may do the following:

- show a picture of an action and let the learner say after you for example the dog is chewing a bone.
- ask the student to repeat a target phrase
- reinforce/reward correct responses
- present a variety of subject/verb combinations until the student correctly and consistently imitates them.
- encourages the student to practice oral skills through story telling.
- encourage music and play games.

Environmental Modification

All learners need a situation of learning that suits their needs. In this component we shall look at modification in relation to children with communication difficulties. Teachers need to make every effort to create a positive, accepting and safe climate for effective learning.



How can you adopt the environment so as to suit learners with communication difficulties?

I hope you mentioned the following:

- refer to children as learners but avoid labelling them reflecting their special needs.
- work closely with speech and language therapists following suggestions and trying to reinforce specific skills.
- encourage the learner
- be positive towards the student
- accept the learner like any other in the class
- encourage group work.
- provide role models and practice appropriate speech and maintain eye contact when the learner speaks
- be a good listener
- don't interrupt to finish the learners sentence or word in the class
- create awareness by sensitizing other learners about speech difficulties so that they may understand and accept other learners
- reward the learner just as you do to others.

Classroom management

- give instructions and important information when distractions are at their lowest.
- use consistent attention – getting devices, either verbal, visual or physical cues.
- be specific when giving instructions and directions
- write directions on the chalkboard, flipchart, or overhead so that students can refer to them.
- call the students by name when talking to them
- emphasize what you are saying by using gestures and facial expressions (body language)
- pair students up with buddies for modelling and support.
- allow for conversation time in the classroom so that learners can share information and ideas.
- encourage learners to use calendars to organize themselves and manage their time.
- organise learning centres and or projects such as nature table in the class.



Suggest any other ways that you would organise your classroom for improved communication.



Parents, siblings, peers, caretakers and teachers play a key role in the development of a child's language. You must therefore involve them in your i n t e r v e n t i o n p r o g r a m m e . . .

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Speech Therapy

This refers to the training activities that you can give a learner to use his speech organs appropriately so as to speak. You can do this by giving him exercises for asking the learner to hold his head as upright as possible and ask him to exercise his:

- lips
- tongue
- soft palate

Let us describe these briefly:

Exercises for the lips

- open his mouth as wide as he can. If he is unable to do this by himself, hold his chin with your thumb and his upper jaw with your index finger and slowly open and close his mouth three or four times.
- spread his lips as far as he can. If he is unable to do this, then place your thumb on one of his cheeks and your index finger on the other then slowly spread his lips sideways three or four times.
- protrude his lips as far as he can. If he is unable to do this, then gently bring the lips together using your fingers and the thumb and pull them to a protruding position three or four times.
- close his lips tightly

Exercises for the tongue

Ask the learner to hold his head as upright as possible and:

- stick the tongue out as far as it can go
- pull the tongue back into the mouth and close the lips
- push the tongue out and move it around, licking the lips
- spread some thing sweet like honey on the child's lips and let him/her lick it off.
- push the tongue out and aim at touching his nose

- push the tongue out then move it up and down

- ask the child to chew some food such as chewing gum
- suck some sweets
- put honey on the sides of the mouth and ask the learner to lick it

Exercise for the soft palate

Ask the learner to hold his head as upright as possible and;

- blow out a burning candle. Move the candle further away each time until the learner cannot blow it out.
- blow paper balls paced on a table in order to pass them between two bottles
- make bubbles in a glass of water using a straw
- drink water or soda from a bottle or glass using a straw



Do these exercise as often as possible. If you need to assist the learner, be very gentle and careful. Make the exercise a game, not a chore.

Remedial Teaching

Remediation may be an individualised or group instruction to improve the basic skills of reading, writing, speaking and or mathematical concepts. Now let us look at the remediation procedures for children with communication difficulties.



What can you do as a teacher to minimise difficulties experienced by learners with communication difficulties?

It is important to note that many of the speech problems that learners demonstrate while young can be corrected and modified with therapy. Teachers should focus

on giving learners strategies for successful learning. These could be done using interesting and meaningful activities that learners can use to maximize their academic and social strengths. The teacher needs to restructure learning situations and requirements.

You can do the following activities to remediate learners with communication difficulties.

- relaxation and breathing exercises.
- encourage the learners to participate in groups in which responses do not have to be individually generated.
- teach learners to be self reinforce by recognizing when they are doing well and by appreciating themselves.
- ask learners to practice skills with a friend in real situations so that they are not afraid or nervous in the real situation.
- ask learners to tape record their own speech and listen carefully for errors so that they can discriminate between correct and incorrect sounds.
- help them to come up with strategies for dealing with people or situations that make them nervous such as walking away, counting to 10 before they speak, deep breathing among others.



Discuss with a colleague some measures you have taken to assist a learner with communication difficulties in your school.

Educating learners with Mental Disabilities

As you learnt in Module 1: Introduction to Children with Special Needs, these learners can be categorized in four groups depending on the severity of their problem, their adaptive behaviour and their educational performance.

Intervention strategies to support learners with mental disability

Intervention strategies are methods and techniques you can use to address the problems a learner may have. These strategies tend to vary depending on the severity of the disability.



Refer to Module 1 about the various categories of mental Disability.

Below are some ways in which you can reduce academic and daily living skills problems of children with mental disability.

You will need to train them in skills that will enable them to be:

- socially competent
- personally adequate
- academically functional
- self confident
- competent in language skills
- able to exhibit good habits of health, safety, work and play
- able to acquire vocational skills
- competent in communication skills
- able to follow directions
- able to perform motor activities

As you teach the skills mentioned above, make sure that you assess the learners weaknesses and strengths and plan the teaching accordingly. You will learn more about these in Module 16: Teaching and Learning Strategies.

You cannot help these learners adequately if you are carrying out whole class teaching. Thus you have to individualize instructions to reach the learners level of ability.

You can achieve this by:

- instructional differentiation
- adaptation of instructional materials
- environmental adaptations

- activities of daily living instructions
- appropriate teaching and learning strategies

Instructional differentiation



How can you differentiate instructions to suit the learner?

As you learnt about the Individualised Education Programm (IEP) in the earlier section of teaching learners with specific learning difficulties, the learner with mental disability should be understood as an individual by being assessed to establish his level of performance.

Based on the understanding of his abilities, interests, strengths and weaknesses, you may:

- adjust his learning pace
- modify the content so that he is presented with what he can be able to do



How else can you differentiate instruction to enable the learner to achieve success in the learning activities?



Discuss with a colleague.

You will learn more about differentiation of instructions in Module 14: Curriculum Development and Adaptation Module 16: Teaching and Learning Strategies.

Adaptation of instructional materials

As you present instructional materials to the learners with mental disabilities, always consider his level of functioning.

This requires you to:

- avoid giving them abstract materials
- present them with concrete materials
- give clear examples
- present simple materials with explanations
- avoid putting too much details in the learning materials to avoid confusion.



Remember learners with mental disability may have difficulty focusing on details and may forget information too quickly.

As you learnt in Module 4: Introduction to Educational Resources 1 - Theory about the materials that you can use to train the learner with mental disability various skills including:

- daily living skills
- perceptual training
- academic skills
- communication skills

Now let us look at how to adapt the environment to cater for these learners.

Environmental adaptations

As you are aware, learners with mental disability may have short attention span and poor cognitive abilities. Therefore ensure that in the classroom and school environment, you:

- reduce distractions by keeping his desk and the paths clear
- avoid presenting too many learning materials hanging on the walls • sit the hyperactive learner by the wall with bigger learners beside him.
- assign the learner tasks to move around the classroom such as handing out materials to others.
- always remove objects not needed in the lesson
- where possible invite a volunteer to come to class and assist you to provide one – to – one attention to the child.

Activities of daily living instructions



What do you understand by the term activities of daily living?

These are skills that an individual does everyday in order to operate as independently as possible within his environment. They include among others:

- hygiene and good grooming
- personal care and clothing
- feeding skills
- social skills



These skills are learnt naturally by growing children but since learners with mental disabilities are forgetful, you may need to train them and constantly remind them.

Hygiene and good grooming

Activities of personal hygiene are those that makes one presentable by looking neat.



List down activities that a learner with mental disability needs to be trained on.



Discuss with a colleague.

Personal care and clothing

These are skills that the learner with mental disability needs to be trained in. They include:

- bathing skills
- dressing skills
- toilet training

Feeding skills

The learners need to be trained in these skills in order to eat independently and gracefully.



Which feeding habits may pose a difficulty to the learner with mental disability?



Discuss with a colleague

Social skills

These are skills that enable us to interact with others in the home, school or the community. Learners with mental disabilities may find difficulties in these skills and may need training in social interaction in the following areas:

- greeting people
- being courteous
- establishing and maintaining relationships
- general manners



Discuss with a colleague how to teach the learner these skills.

Teaching and learning strategies for learners with mental disability To

effectively teach these learners, you need to:

- demonstrate to the learner what you want him to do rather than simply telling.
- use simple words when giving instructions and check the learner understands
- link lessons to the learner's experiences and everyday life.
- do one activity at a time and complete it.
- break the task into small steps. Have learner start with what he can do before moving to a harder step. (task analysis)
- give plenty of praise and encouragement when the learner is successful.
- give the learner extra practice at doing the task to ensure mastery. This is called over learning.
- give the learner opportunity to practise the skills with different materials such as flashcards, worksheets or book, sand, finger paint, crayons and so on.
- pair the learner with a peer to help him focus on given activities

- ignore undesirable behaviour if its for attention seeking by the learner.
- refer the learner for appropriate professional assistance if need be.



Discuss with a colleague the appropriate professional services that the learner with mental disability may need.

Section 4: Early Childhood Development and Education

You learnt about the importance of early childhood education during the first five years of life Module 7: Early Childhood Care Development and Education. The learner with special needs also needs to participate in this programme in order to foster healthy growth, learning and development.



It is important for the learner to be provided with appropriate materials, guidance, stimulation and care during this important phase of rapid development.

The suitable activities that the learners need to participate in at this stage include:

- social environment and social activities
- communication activities
- spontaneous play
- directed play
- development and independent living skills (DILS)

Let us discuss these briefly.

Social, Environmental and Science activities



Refer to 7: Early Childhood Care Development and Education to remind yourself of the various activities.

You should involve the learner with special needs in each of these activities by adapting materials and teaching methods to enable him to express himself in his own way. Such activities also develop the learner's creativity, observation and sense of analysis.

Communication Activities

Communication refers to the transmission and reception of information through a common system of symbols. This may be in form of writing or signs, gestures and expressive movement or spoken words. In an earlier section in this unit, you learnt about alternative modes of communication and also in Module 4: Introduction to Educational Resources – Theory you covered modes of communication.



Refer to Module 7: Early Childhood Care Development and Education for more information on communication skills.

At the early childhood stage, it is important that you engage your learners in the following communication activities:

- oral skills such as production of speech sounds in preparation for saying words which are usually developed from babbling syllables like /“ba”/
- ba/ba/ta/ta/gg among others.
- pre-reading skills such as recognition of different shapes, this may assist the learner to communicate through symbols.

- pre- braille activities such as feeling texture of different surfaces – these prepare the learner to comprehend hence use Braille symbols to communicate .
- pre-sign language activities such as gestures and facial expression among others – which eventually develop to sign language.



Discuss with a colleague why you think communication skills are important in the development of communication

Spontaneous play



What do you understand by spontaneous play?

Spontaneous play refers to activities that learners can do freely as they play. However, as a teacher, you will need to be around them to encourage their participation and ensure safety. You should provide adequate and suitable play materials.



List some spontaneous play activities you may plan for young learners.

I hope you mentioned the following:

- swinging with rope or tyre structures
- throwing, dodging and catching small objects using balls or beanbags
- skipping and jumping with or without ropes

- aiming and hitting objects with balls or beanbags
- sliding down smoothly structured frames
- balancing on low and horizontally fixed boards
- bouncing balls
- kicking balls freely
- racing using tyres or hoops



The young learner with special needs should be encouraged to engage in free play by being paired with peers. However, you have to train him how to perform the activities at his pace.

Directed play activities



What are directed play activities for young learners?

These are activities that you can plan and demonstrate to learners so that they imitate you and acquire the expected skills. You may use older or able-bodied learners to lead others to perform some of these activities. However, you should ensure that all learners get equal chances to lead and play in such activities. Directed activities include:

- running race
- body movements and exercises
- songs and dances



Discuss and demonstrate with a colleague examples of races, Body exercises, songs and dances that you can teach young learners with special needs

I hope you have mentioned the following races:

- sack races
- tyre race
- hopping on one leg race

- filling bottles competition
- running relays

Body movement and exercises include:

- jumping feet astride, (star jump)
- bending forward, backwards, sideways
- running on the spot
- flying kites
- tug – of - war

Songs and dances that you would teach include the following among others:

- killing rats
- what is the time Mr. Lion?
- nyama nyama nyama!
- nyambaga kondo gakwa
- marobo – tanda robo!



You have to use your imagination to ensure the learner with special needs gets the meaning of the activity, participates and enjoys performing the activities safely.

D e v e l o p m e n t a l a n d I n d e p e n d e n t L i v i n g S k i l l s (D I L S)



What are developmental and independent living skills?

These are skills that enable one to carry out day to day activities without assistance or with minimal assistance. They are also referred to as self help skills. You should remember that such skills are mostly learnt through observation and imitation.

Majority of learners with special needs are not able to learn these activities by watching. For example, we all learn how to shave by observing what our fathers do. To a child who is blind in the family the concept of beard is difficult unless you allow the child to touch your chin.



What activities of daily living that we require to train learners with special needs in?

Does your list of activities include the following?:

- personal care and clothing such as bathing, personal hygiene, dressing, toilet training and so on.
- eating skills such as table manners, chewing and serving
- social skills which include greeting, courtesy and relationships
- food selection and preparations
- recreational and leisure time spending



Discuss with a colleague how you can teach a young learner with disability an activity among the given ones. Refer to Module 7: Early Childhood Care Development and Education for more details.



Summary

You have come to the end of Unit 3. In this unit, you have learnt that learners with special needs can learn in regular classrooms with appropriate support. The basis of their support includes:

- positive acknowledgement of their abilities and differences by the society
- provision of remedial instruction
- use of relevant strategies
- provision of specialized services such as physiotherapy

It was emphasised that support for learners with special needs should be individualized to address their unique needs. Support in an inclusive setting should be offered in such away that it enhances the learner's participation in regular instruction.

You also learnt that the learner's environment including the home and school community can provide valuable support. Finally, you noted that it is important to merge remedial instruction with your teaching. Your main aim is to support all learners.

Wish you success as you work with these learners!



Self Test - Unit 3

1. Identify any four factors that are necessary in the provision of a school for all in your area.
(2 marks)
2. Explain why it is important that you involve the community in creating a school for all.
(1 mark)
3. List at least two optical devices for learners with Visual Impairment and briefly explain their importance *(2 marks)*
4. State two ways that you would consider to help a learner with Hearing Impaired in your classroom
(2 marks)
5. State three teaching and learning strategies for learners with physical disabilities? *(3 marks)*

6. State three areas whereby a learner who is gifted and talented may demonstrate his/her their exceptionality.

(3 marks)

7. How can you approach remedial instruction to a learner with Specific Learning Difficulties?

(3 marks)

8. Mention two social skills that a learner with mental disability need to be trained in.

(2 marks)

9. State at least two directed activities that you can use with learners in early childhood

(2 marks)

Score Board

16-20	- Very Good	
13-15	- Good	
10-12	- Satisfactory	
0 - 9	- Read the Unit again	

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Learning Outcomes

You have now completed Unit 3. The learning outcomes are listed below. Put a tick in the column, which reflects your understanding.

No.	Self evaluation	Sure	Not Sure
1	I can explain how we can create a school that welcomes all learners including those with special needs		
2	I can discuss how the community can be involved to include and support learners with special needs.		
3	I can now describe how to address the needs of learners with various special needs including those with disabilities in my classroom		
4	I can explain the activities that young learners need to be taught in an early childhood programme		

If you have put a tick at the not sure column, please go back and study that section in the unit. If you are sure, proceed to Unit 4.

You have now come to the end of this unit.



Well Done!

Unit 4

Barriers to Implementation of Inclusive Education

Introduction

Welcome to Unit 4: Barriers to Implementation of Inclusive Education. In this Unit, you will learn about the barriers to inclusive education and how you can overcome them in order to facilitate learning for all children.

Aim

This unit aims at equipping you with knowledge, skills and attitudes to enable you to identify barriers that mitigate against inclusive education and what you can do with other partners to embrace inclusive education for all learners.



Objective

By the end of this unit you should be able to

- discuss barriers to inclusive education.
- describe how the barriers can be overcome to facilitate inclusive education for all learners.

The Unit is divided into two sections namely:

Section 1: Barriers to Inclusive Education

Section 2: Overcoming barriers to Inclusive Education

Section 1: Barriers to Inclusive Education.

This section highlights the various factors that may hinder the practice of inclusive education. You may have noted that most of our schools may not be able to accommodate learners with various diversities of learning needs. This is because of the prevailing barriers in our education, social, political and economic systems.

Barriers noted to hinder progress of education for all learners include:

- lack of appropriate national policy and legislations • unfriendly learning environment and classroom factors
- delayed identification and intervention.
- learner factors (severity, onset and nature)- diversity of learners
- negative attitude of teachers including lack of specialized training
- poor community involvement
- teacher and school management
- inadequate parental involvement
- curriculum barriers
- communication between the teacher and the learner
- rigid education approaches, evaluation and promotion criteria
- insufficient/lack of material resources
- insufficient human resources
- discriminative cultural factors
- political and economic factors • lack of resourcefulness of facilities.

Let us discuss them briefly.

Lack of policy and legislation

As you learnt in Unit 3 of this module, there are various government policy guidelines concerning special needs but implementation is not clear. For example, teachers posted to work with children with special needs in inclusive schools are not paid the special allowance that their colleagues in special schools are paid. This demotivates them.

- a policy on the provision of learning resources to children in inclusive programmes should be made clearer. If done, the teachers will feel encouraged.
- the ratio of learners with special needs and disabilities to regular learners in a class or school is not stipulated by the Ministry of Education.
- no clear guidelines or adequate preparation to minimise suspicion between parents and schools. For example, in free primary education, there is confusion as it seems it is a crime for school heads to ask parents to contribute towards management of some urgent school activities like repairs and or provision of furniture.
- insufficient political will at national, regional, provincial, district, zonal, community and school levels to enforce the inclusive education practices and punish those promoting exclusive practices.
- resistance to change and release of power by policy makers and professionals at various levels including the persons with special needs themselves and their parents. Parents may prefer to maintain the status quo to enjoy the caring protective environment and facilities in special schools.

You may have realised that in integrated programmes parents hold separate meetings that is parents of the learners with special needs in the unit and those of the regular children.

- educational managers who hold to the top-bottom approach while inclusion requires also bottom – up two way approach for full participation of all. This applies to the relationship of learners-teachers, teachers-headteacher, headteachers- field officers, officers in the Ministry of Education and so on.
- Most of the available legislation that support special needs such as the disability Act, children's Act and other are not specific about inclusive education practices required of all players.

- There should be a policy to determine which category of learners may remain in special schools.



Legislation should be put in place to ensure effective organisation and implementation of special needs programmes. Each stakeholder will be held responsible and this will promote accountability.

Unfriendly learning environment and school related factors

These include the following among others:

- Most classrooms lack organisation with learning/teaching centres or corners such as nature corners and project areas.
- lack of guidance to school community and in servicing of teachers.
- lack of understanding of the inclusion philosophy by teachers and other school community.
- lack of other proper and adequate facilities and infrastructure such as sanitation facilities.
- no acoustically treated classrooms.
- lack of or inadequate adaptations in public and private buildings to allow easy access and mobility of persons with disabilities.
- large teacher/pupils ratio (overcrowded classes).
- shortage of secure accommodation in day institutions and long-distance travel.
- poor teaching and learning approaches.
- unlockable doors and windows
- dirty and dusty classrooms
- limited ventilation and lighting

Delayed identification and intervention

This can be observed in:

- late identification hence intervention leading to late starting in school
- lack of awareness of educational and assessment services.



Check if the learners with special needs in your school have been given medical and other intervention. Refer them to appropriate service providers if need be

Learner factors (severity onset and nature) – Diversity of Learners

These refer to factors in the learner that may affect his/her learning and development. They include:

- whether his/her disability is mild, moderate or severe
- health problems. A learner might be out of school often to seek medical attention and this may affect his/her performance.
- age of onset of the disability or difficulties in academic operations will also impact on his/her learning for example the difficulty is congenital or acquired later in life.
- the nature of the special need for example if the problem is general mental disability or specific learning difficulties.



Refer to Unit 2 Section 2 in this module for more information

Negative attitude of teachers, parents and other stakeholders



How are the learners with SNE viewed by the community, parents and educators? Compare your response with the following observations

In many African Communities, disabilities are explained to be resulting from God's punishment for some wrongs done to the ancestors or to some persons problems. As such, the child experiencing any of these conditions is seen as a curse or possessed by the spirits. Such superstitions have led many parents who give birth to children who deviate from the 'normal' to hide the child, hence deny him access to education.

Other negative attitudes by the community include stereotypic beliefs such as: A mother who gets a baby with albinism has been adulterous and if a pregnant woman looks at a person with physical disability she will get a baby with physical disabilities.

- education is seen in terms of a good job and an investment hence, academic excellence is a must.
- lack of good will and moral support from stakeholders due to ignorance; misinformation and priorities.
- other stakeholders in the community may feel that they should not provide for the learner with special needs because they are not directly responsible.

Poor community involvement

The community may fail to support inclusive education by not:

- contributing towards construction of school building by providing local materials such as bricks, stones, sand and labour;
- encouraging members to send children to school;
- contributing ideas to the teaching and learning programmes;
- monitoring the discipline of school children both within and outside the school;

- contributing ideas to the teaching and learning programmes;
- monitoring the discipline of school children both within and outside the school;
- establishing and sustaining the school as a social service.



Negative attitudes usually arise from ignorance and fear of the unknown.

The effects of these attitudes may be reflected on parents, educators, policy makers among others as follows:

Parents

- parents may prioritize taking their other children without special needs to school and only considering the one with special needs if finances are still available.
- low expectations from the learners with special needs leading to low self esteem in the learner.
- the elite parents have already set goals and expectations from their children as such failure in school is not entertained or accepted. Children should be like their parents or better than them.
- some parents may tend to be overprotective towards the child with special needs, thus preventing him/her from taking part in daily life activities. This may hamper the child's possibilities to develop his/her potentials.
- some parents of learners without special needs may oppose having those

with special needs in the same class fearing that the education of their children will be adversely affected.

Teachers and school management

- some teachers may object to having learners with special needs in their class or school fearing that the learner will lower the mean score for their class or school. This result from assessment made which is geared towards exams.
- many teachers think that working with a child with disability or other special needs calls for technical training.
- special needs education has been mystified by the belief that it is very special and only for “special teachers” trained in a special institution. Such teachers are considered capable of working in a special school with a special learner using special equipment. This has led to even the education officers avoiding to carry out inspection in special education programmes as they may not understand the “special world”. Thus the regular teacher may refer
the learner with special needs to the special school or unit, hence denying them the chance to learn in the natural setting in the neighbourhood school.
- the teacher may have low expectations from the learner with special needs and may not give him/her challenging work. This may make the learner give up trying, as his/her efforts are not appreciated.
- some school administrators and policy makers in education feel that it is improper to ‘waste’ scarce resources on learners with special needs while the ‘normal’ ones do not have enough, hence unsupportive to inclusion of such learners in the mainstream school.
- the charity model to disability and special needs provision has also led the community and other stakeholders to leave education of learners with special needs as a responsibility of churches and voluntary organizations. This makes the learners develop a sense of dependence and does not equip them with a life-long education to live independently in the world after school. Special education has been linked to human rights, kindness and charitable philosophy.
- resistance to change if one feels his/her job is threatened, particularly if one has experienced failure in his/her class.

- fear of responsibility and stress from added responsibility.
- feeling of being exploited (more work without extra pay)
- fear of being displaced (mainly teachers in special schools).
- teachers may view inclusion as a foreign ideology which is not workable in their classroom.

Inadequate parental involvement

Parents may fail in the following ways:-

- little or no collaboration betwe



With your colleague discuss the roles of parents in the education of their children.

Curriculum barriers

In Section 1 of Unit 2, you learnt that an appropriate curriculum is vital for inclusive education to be meaningful for learners with special needs in an inclusive setting. However, according to the Koech Report (1999) the Kenyan School Curriculum is inappropriate in that there is:

- inadequate educational facilities, equipment and services for children with special needs including those with disabilities.
- inadequate trained personnel who use rigid teaching approaches which may only benefit the average learner;
- almost no provision for educating some groups of learners such as the gifted and talented as well as those living in difficult circumstances;

- irrelevant and overloaded content in the curriculum;
- rigid assessment procedures based on mean score competition, which does not consider learners with special needs;
- failure of the curriculum to address the specific subjects that would cater for special needs of learners for life long education;
- the curriculum content is too wide making it difficult to assist learners with special needs;
- limited flexibility of the curriculum because learners are exposed to the same curriculum whereby they are expected to pass same examinations. Some learners cannot cope with the extensive content;
- Curriculum is too rigid, that is not flexible for specific needs of learners;
- assessment or evaluation criteria is too much exam oriented;
- laying a lot of emphasis in the media about the children/candidates who had excelled in National Examinations. This makes the schools not willing to admit learners who have special needs;
- assessment geared towards the spirit of competition rather than co-operation;
- geographical locations of schools especially in rural areas;
- time allocated for the subject content coverage and exams is the same for all learners;
- highly politicised education. Education policies issued usually for political gains.

Communication between the teacher and the learner

- lack of common language as Kenya has more than 42 tribes including the 'deaf community' each with its own language;
- Kenyan sign language not yet an official language as such the learners with hearing impaired are examined in spoken and written spoken language (i.e. English and Kiswahili);
- transition period from home to school and the language of instruction teachers use in school. Poor mastery of language can be a cause of learning difficulties.
- Teachers, inability to communicate in a medium of instruction which the learner understands;
- lack of individual attention to learners due to large teacher: pupil ratio.

Rigid educational approaches, evaluation and promotion criteria

These can be seen in:

- poor quality teacher training in which there is lack of long-term professional development. inservice training for teachers is rarely required or planned for teachers in regular schools.
- the teachers use methods that aim at the middle range or average learners.
- the competition that is emphasized in the examinations and selection of learners for promotion to higher levels by mean score does not consider learners with special needs.
- basing evaluation of academic success on terminal examinations such as end of primary or secondary examinations rather than on the covered learning activities.

Insufficient/lack of resources

As you are aware, since the introduction of Free Primary Education in 2003, the government has taken the responsibility of all the public primary schools. In this regard, it has taken over the whole responsibility of providing instructional materials and developing school facilities.

Despite all that schools are experiencing difficulties in:

- debts in terms of salaries to workers, unpaid bills and deteriorating school infrastructure;
- lack of equipment like assistive devices such as the hearing aids are expensive hence parents cannot afford to buy them;
- limited trained personnel, for example a high number of teachers are untrained in special needs education, peripatetic teachers, among others;
- inadequate and inappropriate resources both assistive and compensatory devices;
- limited supervision of schools;
- limited collaboration among special needs education support systems.

Insufficient human resources

These aspects have been mentioned briefly in the previous section. However, it is important to emphasise that unless learners with special needs are provided with the appropriate resources, it will not be possible for them to benefit in mainstream education.



Inclusive education does not mean less resources for special needs, but efficiency and equity in the use of available resources among those with special needs in the school.

It has been noted that currently, most regular schools lack:

- adequately trained teachers and other support staff with knowledge in special needs.

- required assistive devices and equipment to support learning for those with special needs.
- staff with guidance and counselling skills to support learners in difficult circumstances and their teachers.

Discriminative cultural factors

- cultures that view the needs of the male child above the girls.
- girls' education is viewed as unnecessary/unacceptable cost.
- harmful traditional practices and attitudes which inflict physical and psychological damage to the children for example initiation rituals and early marriages among others.
- family instability (separation/divorce) which deprives the children of the love and security of one or both parents and fosters sexual abuse.
- insecure environment in and outside school which may be physical, social or psychological conditions. These may bring low self-esteem amongst learners.
- long distances between the home and school leaving the children easy prey to sexual harassment and other forms of abuse.
- religious practices that may regard disabilities as a sign of God's disfavour to be the child or the parents. For example, you may have realised that in the Holy Bible, individuals with physical disabilities (cripple), paralysed, hearing impaired (deaf dumb), blind (visual impaired) mental disabilities, were portrayed to be possessed by demons which Jesus cursed out.

Political and economic factors:

These are indicated by:

- failure to enforce available laws and regulations, which would otherwise protect children and ensure equitable allocation of educational funds.

- the planning and management processes at central, district and community levels are not sufficiently sensitive to the needs of children.
- poverty constraints that limit choices available to parents even if they are concerned about their children's education.
- high dependence on international donors to fund schools
- burden of donor debts affecting the economy because the debts have to be serviced
- high unemployment rates leading to malnutrition and lack of basic provisions to children
- limited economic growth and this limits the government from meeting the needs of all the citizens
- corruption amongst leaders who divert funds meant for learners with special needs
- liberalization and retrenchment causing losses of steady income in many families.

Lack of resourcefulness of facilities



How does lack of resourcefulness affect efficient inclusion of all learners in education?

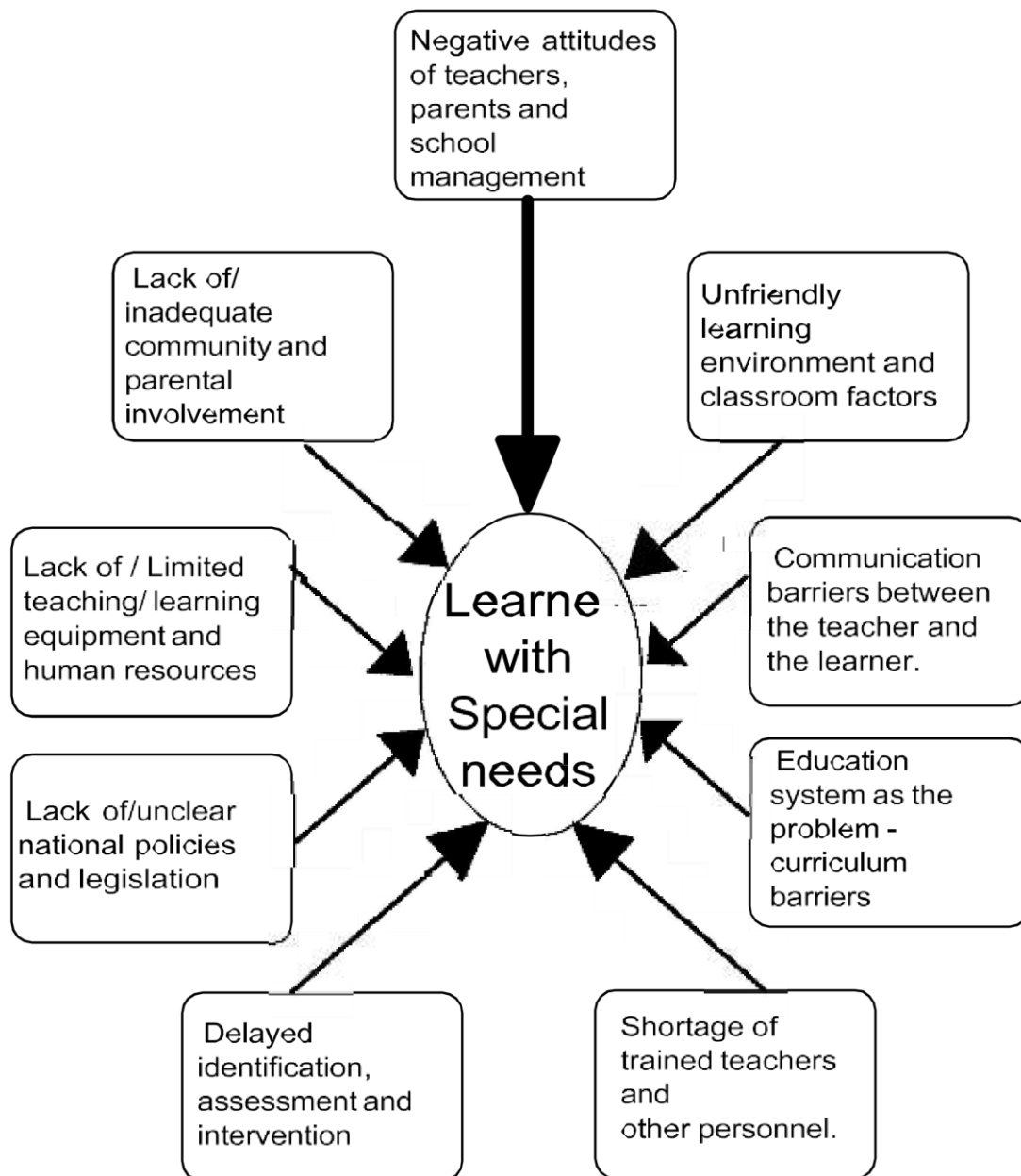
I hope you have mentioned the following:

- Learning materials prepared for learners with special needs are used on very few such learners while they could reach more learners if they were learning in inclusive setting.
- Teachers do not share teaching resources with colleagues and the locked up resources end up being waste as they age while they would have benefited more learners.

- A lot of community resources lie idle for most periods while they could facilitate inclusive education activities. For example, mosques and church buildings are used only a few days in a week, while schools around them are overcrowded. These barriers can be summarised in the table 4.1.

Table 4.1 Factors that may hinder the inclusion of children with special needs in regular schools

ly.



Section 2: Overcoming Barriers to Inclusive Education

In Section 1, you learnt about barriers to inclusive Education. In this section you will learn how to overcome these barriers for successful implementation of inclusive education.

The following ways may help to overcome the barriers:

- flexible and child centred curriculum
- considering the learners diversity
- developing educational and legal policies that enhance inclusion
- early identification and intervention
- flexibility and diversity of educational approaches
- availability of human and material resources • sensitization of the community on special needs
- availing funds for inclusive education.
- education reforms

Let us now discuss each of them:



What are the possible ways to overcome barriers to inclusive education?

Flexible and child centred curriculum considering learners diversity

Activities to achieve these include:

- diversifying the curriculum to suit individual learner's needs.
- adapting examination questions to suit the individual learner's needs.
- using alternative ways of measuring the learner's competence such as:
 - Continuous assessment over the whole year through portfolio of best work done
 - Project work

- Direct observation as the learners work
- Functional assessment as learners demonstrate skills
- Students self-assessment.
- facilitating individual schools and teachers to adapt the curriculum to local needs and cultural differences by developing other content areas appropriate to the learners needs.
- allowing learners with special needs more time for content coverage during examinations.
- include specific subjects that are particularly crucial to learners with special needs.
- make learning enjoyable by involving learners in different activities
- make education more relevant to daily life and home situations
- accept that children learn at different rates and vary teaching methods accordingly
- respond flexibly and creatively to the individual needs of learners
- be flexible about seating arrangements – use mats, wooden blocks or old car tyres
- promote active learning and child-to-child activities
- encourage teachers to observe each other and solve problems together



How can you improve communication between you and the learners?

You can do this by:

- using of total communication.
- sign language to be taught in all schools and be examined like any other language.
- using simple, clear and consistent language



Which subjects that are particularly important to learners with special needs.

Subjects relevant to learners with special needs include the following among others:

- independent living skills for learners with visual, hearing, mental and physical difficulties.
- braille for those with visual problems.
- orientation and mobility skills for independent travel for the visually, and physically challenged.
- sign language for those with hearing problems.
- physiotherapy for those with physical problems especially for learners with visual and physical impairments.
- include specific subjects that are particularly crucial to learners with special needs
- perceptual skills training for learners with sensory impairments



The specific subjects to be taught to each learner will be dictated by the learner's needs.

Developing education and legal policies that enhance inclusion

- with proper legislation and policy, teachers can be held responsible for the learning of children in special needs.
- education should be delinked from politics and involve education technocrats more in decision making.
- carry out situations analysis
- select pilot schools for inclusive education
- lobby for system change in education
- promote inclusive policies and legislation
- develop clear policy and legislation for inclusive education practices

Early Identification and intervention

According to UNESCO (2001) identification of children who may be experiencing difficulties in learning should lead to intervention measures which promote learning and social development as early as possible. The interventions can be done at home, in pre- school, or in the schools as soon as a special need or disability is identified. The identification and intervention measures include:

- taking the child for screening and assessment at the nearest educational assessment and resource centre (EARC).

- referral for medical intervention such as treatment, therapy or provision of assistive devices.
- starting stimulation programmes in collaboration with parents and Early Childhood Care Development and Education staff to stimulate language development. Provide adequate nutrition and manage behaviour difficulties in children.

Flexibility and diversity of Educational Approaches.

These can be achieved through the following:

- establishing a comprehensive educational system which goes beyond schooling and which targets all the members of the community regardless of their age, gender, ability, ethnicity, disability or HIV status.
- regular inservicing of teachers through seminars, workshops, conferences, lectures, symposia, leaflets and media appeals organized in a structured way.
- promotion of collaborative learning and teaching approaches in all learning experiences. Networking with other professionals especially the community and Community Based Rehabilitation (CBR) workers.
- differentiating curriculum implementation and evaluation procedures as discussed earlier. Each learner's progress should be recognized and celebrated.
- increase literacy among adults to improve access to accurate information and knowledge, about special needs including disabilities.
- the media to play a major role in changing traditional attitudes, values or beliefs towards persons with disabilities.
- discussion groups in CBR settings on disabilities to share accurate information.
- identification of children with special needs in regular school and providing appropriate services for them

- unconditional commitment to equalizing education opportunities for children with special needs such as:
 - Early identification of children with special needs and inclusion in early childhood education programmes.
 - Enabling accessibility to social services for persons with disabilities.
 - Resources and funds to be provided by the government and local authorities as well as community members.
 - Legislation to be put in place to back up inclusive education policies.
 - Public education.



We need a twin-pack approach for inclusion by making the education system inclusive and also paying attention to the specific needs of individual learners.

Availability of human and materials resources.

This can be facilitated by doing the following:

- support from the educational administration to finance the adaptation and modification of the learning environment for learners with special needs to be accommodated in the class or school. The need for updating class teachers' teaching skills. This can be achieved through the many activities suggested in the earlier section such as seminars and workshops.

- curriculum materials and resources to be put in accessible formats and displaying positive images of children with all types of difference.
- training of teachers in special needs education to meet the demand.

The organizations and for persons with disabilities and others should be recognised as they provide the much required assistive and corrective devices for learners with special needs. However, networking between the agencies is vital for efficiency.

Organisations such as:

- Christoffel Bliden Mission (CBM)
- Kenya Society For The Blind (KSB)
- Kenya Union Of The Blind(KUB)
- United Disabled Persons of Kenya(UDPK)
- Sight Savers International ,Kenya National Association For The Deaf (KNAD)
- Association For The Physically Disabled Of Kenya (APDK)
- Kenya Society For Deaf Children (KSDC)
- Kenya Society For The Mentally Handicapped (KSMH)
- the government providing more finances to supply and maintain the devices.



Students with disabilities are different but valuable. They deserve a place in a world that values them.

Sensitization of the Community on Special Needs issues



How can we as teachers overcome negative attitudes in the community towards learners with special needs?

This can be done by:

- creating awareness about the nature, causes, prevention and intervention of conditions that create special needs.

- encouraging others to accept learners with special needs including disabilities as part of their lives.
- encouraging the learners with special needs to accept their situation.
- promoting cultural activities such as drama, poems and songs to teach the community about the issues of special needs education.
- teaching parents to nurture their families before, during and after pregnancy by maintaining balanced diet and emotional well being of their familymembers.
- using mass media to educate the public about special needs issues with an emphasis on the right of every child to education.
- guiding and counselling parents, other learners, and teachers on how to deal with difficulties in the education process resulting from special needs including disabilities.
- promoting support for learners and teachers within the community and developing a common goal where co-operation and collaboration is valued at all levels.

Availing Funds for Inclusive Education

It is mistakenly assumed that learners with special needs demand extra resources and funding. However, most countries that have decided to embrace inclusive education have realised that this approach is more cost effective than regular and special education. This is because same resources are utilized to teach more learners if well planned.

Funds can be used more effectively to cater for inclusive education by:

- training non-material resources such as teachers, regular learners, management teams and community to enhance the capacity of the schools to respond to learners diversity.
- establishing resourcing partnerships between the national and local governments with other potential resource providers such as international donors, non governmental organizations, local business and industries of goodwill for financial and technical aid.
- merging funding systems for mainstreaming and special education and allocating funds to schools in relation to the number of learners with and without special needs appropriately.
- Finding simple and cost effective ways of overcoming barriers in the physical environment.



The distribution of funds needs to be strategised to meet the needs of rural and urban schools according to their differences such as levels of need, social-economic status of families and so on.

Educational Reforms

Separate systems of education that is: special schools and regular schools need to be integrated to provide one system, which is able to recognize and respond to the diverse needs of the learners.

*“It is not our education systems that have a right over certain types of children. It is the school of a country that must be adjusted to meet the needs of all children”.
(UNESCO 1997)*



What are the motives behind educational reforms?

In many countries including Uganda, Zambia, Benin, Palestine, Denmark, United Kingdom, United States of America and Kenya, Educational reforms have been started so as to:

- improve students' outcomes for employment.
- get more control over curriculum content and assessment.
- reduce educational costs to the government.
- increase community input to education through direct involvement.
- involve the learners more in decision making about their learning.



The pace and details of reforms vary from one country to another.

However, the reforms have the following characteristics:

- parents are given more choices of schools for their children.
- decision-making is decentralized through local and site-based management on the ground. That is, empowering the school and the class teacher to make decisions concerning learning in the classroom.
- curriculum content and assessment systems are flexible with teachers deciding the most important knowledge, skills and competences that all students must acquire.
- attempts are made to teach a common body of knowledge to the most diverse students within a school.
- it calls for public accountability by publicising the children's performance.

High

expectations lead to better performance.



The current trends in the world call for a new role for special education facilities to open doors to regular schools. The special human and material resources will benefit more learners with increased co-operation and collaboration between the special and regular schools.

The various ways of overcoming barriers to inclusive education are summarised in figure 4.2.

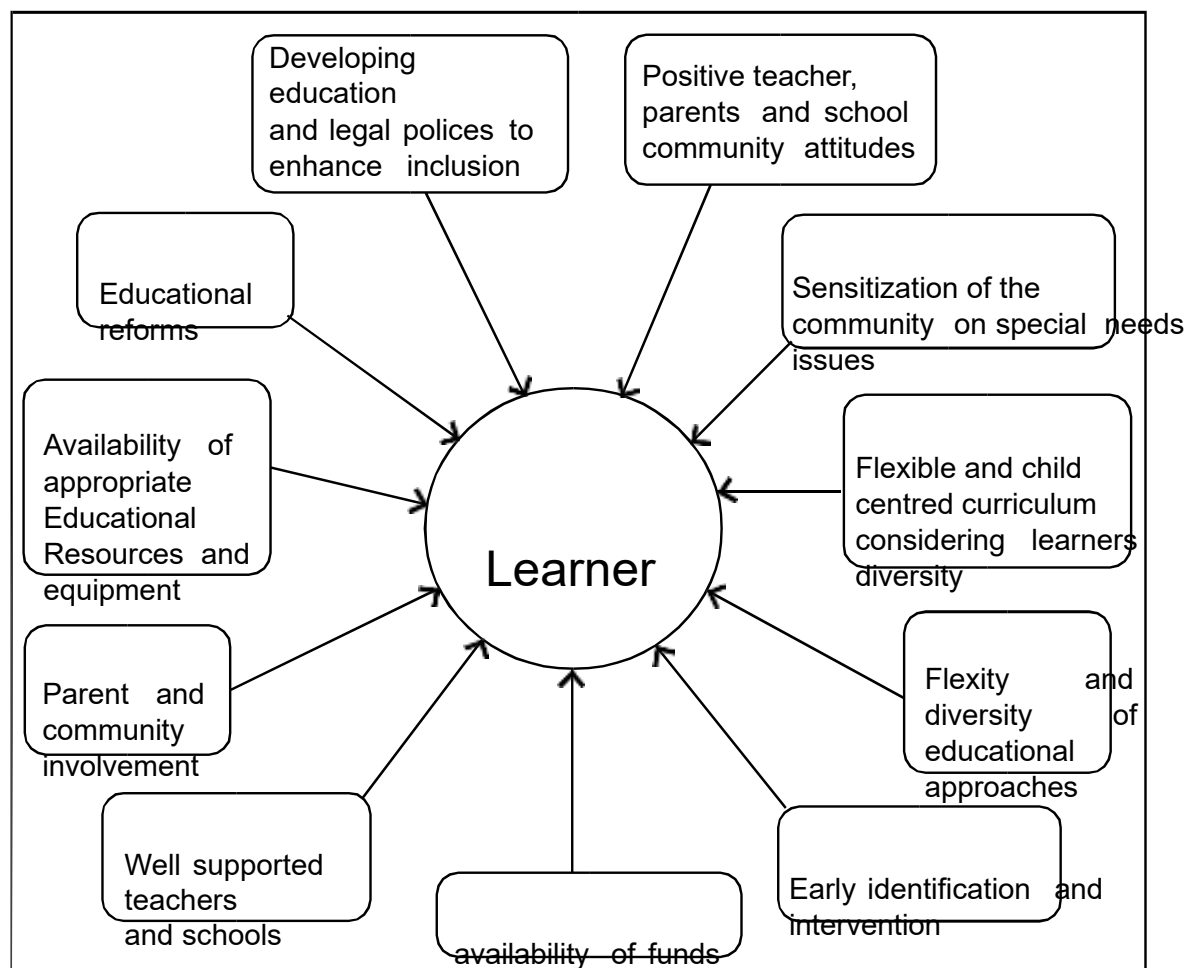


Figure 4.2: Factors that lead to overcoming barriers to inclusive education

I hope you will advocate for these reforms in your station of work to enhance of inclusion practices for our learners.



Summary

You have come to the end of Unit 4. In this unit, you learnt about the barriers that make it difficult to implement inclusive education. These include:

- negative attitudes of teachers, parents, learners, school administrators and community.
- lack of clear special education policies and inadequate legislation to back inclusive education.
- Inflexible curriculum and rigid teaching and evaluation methods.
- inadequate resources and educational facilities among others.

You also learnt how you can assist in overcoming the barriers to inclusive education by:

- sensitizing the pupils, other teachers, parents and school administration to understand the learners with special needs and support them in learning and other activities.
- advocating for flexible and accommodating teaching approaches and provision of appropriate learning resources.
- more parental and community involvement in school activities to support learners with special needs.
- more networking between teachers, other professionals and special schools to utilize available resources to benefit all children among others.

I hope you enjoyed reading this unit. Now attempt the following self test.



Self Test - Unit 4

Answer ALL Questions

1. Which curriculum issues can hinder a learner with special needs from succeeding in learning in a regular school?
(2 marks)
2. How can you address the problem of inadequate resources as you attempt to include some learners with special needs in your classroom?
(3 marks)
3. Who are the stakeholders that you need to work with to facilitate inclusion of all learners in the school?
(2 marks)
4. Explain why inclusive education is considered to be cost – effective
(2 marks)
5. Why is late identification and assessment considered as a barrier to inclusive education?
(1 mark)

Score Board

9 - 10	- Very Good	
7 - 8	- Good	
5 - 6	- Satisfactory	
0 - 4	- Read the Unit again	



Learning Outcomes

You have now completed unit 4. The learning outcomes are listed below. Put a tick in the column, which reflects your understanding.

No.	Self evaluation	Sure	Not Sure
1	I can explain the barriers to inclusive education		
2	I can now discuss how the various barriers to inclusive education can be addressed to enable all learners including those with special needs to access education		

If you have put a tick at the not sure column, please go back and study that section in the unit.

You have now come to the end of this module.



Congratulations!



Answers to Self Test - Unit 1

1. C (1 mark)
2. Differentiate between integration and inclusive education
Integration
 - attempts to change the learner
 - Curriculum does not change
 - No support to cater for those with special needs
 - Learner viewed differently in class

Inclusive education

- No attempts to change the learner
- Curriculum modified to cater for learners with special needs
- Both the physical and social environments are modified to accommodate the diversity of the learners.

(4 marks)

3. Four examples of resources in a resources room
 - white cane
 - hearing aids
 - callipers
 - models of various objects such as

- pots and mats

4. Matching responses A – B

- (a) - c
- (b) - a
- (c) - b

(2 marks)



Answers to SelfTest - Unit 2

1. What to do for Kimosi, a learner who is blind:
 - Make him feel welcome by introducing him to the class and the other learners to him.
 - Find out what visual tasks he can and cannot do.
 - Encourage other learners to work with him to assist him by reading the teacher's instructions to him, showing him, around the classroom and the compound, playing with him and talking with him.
 - Plan learning activities to involve him as part of a group and use methods that are more tactile than visual.
 - Use more real objects and models in the learning activities.
 - Discuss with other teachers how to work with him.
 - Consult with an itinerant teacher or EARC staff how to modify instructions and exercises for him.
 - Invite his parents to plan and supervise his work in school and at home together with you.
 - Providing white cane to aid mobility
-

- Introduce him to braille skills
- Fill up ditches on the compound

(any 3 x 1 = 3 marks)

2. Four teaching methods in inclusive education

- Peer tutoring
- Team teaching
- Individual instructions
- Group teaching

(2 marks)

3. Some resources recommended for a resource room

- Specialized equipment such as calliper, clutches, low vision devices braces, magnifying lenses, audio visual equipment, visual aids among others.
- Sensitizing them by giving them information for example on causes of special needs. *(3 marks)*

4. Parents can be involved by

- Encouraging them to be co-teachers
- Advice their children on school work
- Providing their children with stationary and other necessary materials. *(2 marks)*



Answers to SelfTest - Unit 3

1. Four factors that are necessary in the provision of a school for ALL in your area.

- policy and legislation
- well trained teachers
- modification of the learning environment
- adaptation of teaching and learning strategies

(2 marks)

2. Community provides or supplements what the school requires for example provision of teaching/learning materials.

(1 mark) 3. (a)

These include hand held magnifiers, stand magnifiers

(b) They help a learner with low vision to view an object or print clearly

(2 marks)

4. (i) Consider preferential sitting
(ii) Give the child a chance to talk in class

(2 marks)

5. Some teaching strategies to consider for persons with physical disabilities

(i) Allow learner extra time to complete tasks given

- (ii) Encourage interaction between learners
- (iii) Train the learner to use mobility devices

(2 marks)

6. Areas which a gifted and talented learner demonstrates high performance

- (i) General intellectual ability
- (ii) Leadership ability
- (iii) ability in games and sports

(3 marks)

7. Approaches to remedial instruction to a learner with SLD

- (i) Give individual assistance as the rest of the class is doing some task
- (ii) Assign a peer to assist the learner when they are working in groups.
- (iii) Have an assistant teacher to assist the learner as you work with the rest of the class.

(3 marks)

8. Social skills include:

- being courteous
- greeting people
- general manners
- establishing and maintaining relationships

(2 marks)

9. Some directed activities

- (i) Running races
- (ii) Body movement
- (iii) Songs and dances

(2 marks)



Answers to Self Test - Unit 4

1. Curriculum issues hindering a learner with special needs from succeeding in a regular school.
 - rigid assessment procedures
 - inadequate teaching and learning resources
 - overloaded content
 - rigid curriculum for example assessment mode

(2 marks)
 2. How to address the issue of inadequate resources in your classroom
 - improvising the learning/teaching resources
 - liase with organisations like KSDC so that they can assist in providing devices like hearing aids
 - lobbying for funds from the community through government agencies like chiefs

(3 marks)
 3. Stakeholders to work with for the inclusion of all learners.
 - other learners
 - parents
 - social workers
 - professionals within the community and such as physiotherapist and nutritionists

(2 marks)
 4. Inclusion is cost effective because all learners use the same resources.
-

(2 marks)

5. Late identification and assessment are considered a barrier because

intervention is delayed and this may interfere with the outcome.

(1 mark)



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